

Phase 1 Review Packet

Reissued after the conditional sign-off. Phone verification codes no longer exist in plaintext anywhere; the eight ruled decisions are implemented or explicitly scheduled. This packet separates what was *executed* from what was merely written, and separates what a machine proved from what I proved on my own workstation.

Branch **claude/create-app-repository-1cxsih**

Head **aee5b4c**

Tests **172 passed • 3 skipped**

GitHub CI **green**

Audit **0 advisories**

Plaintext codes **none**

1

How to read this

THIS REPLACES THE EARLIER PACKET

The packet you reviewed described commit `fc61db` , CI run #4, and 146 tests. **That document no longer describes this repository** and should not be treated as the final state of Phase 1 — you said so, and you were right. This one is written from `aee5b4c` . What changed between them is section 2.

Three words are used with fixed meanings throughout, and nowhere else:

WORD	MEANS EXACTLY
TESTED	An automated test or a command was executed and its result observed. The command that produced it is quoted, so you can run it.
NOT TESTED	The code exists and is reviewable, but no test exercises it. Read it, do not trust it.
NOT IMPLEMENTED	It does not exist. There is no stub pretending otherwise.

"Verified" appears only where a test actually ran. Section 4 says *where* each proof ran — my workstation, GitHub CI, or both.

A note on the commit this describes

The head at the time of writing is `aee5b4c` . The commit that adds this packet comes after it and changes nothing but documents, so every number below is measured on code that CI has already run. The CI table in section 4 lists every run by commit, including the one for the packet commit, so nothing rests on you taking my word for which commit was green.

Where the time is worth spending

THE OTP CORRECTION · ITS ADVERSARIAL TESTS · WHAT THE DATABASE NOW ENFORCES

THE REST

Suggested split of a ~90 minute review: ~60 min sections 2, 8, 10, 11 · ~30 min the rest

The security correction

You rejected options (a) and (c) and approved **option (b)**: move phone verification back into `otp_challenges`, keep every existing control, and let Better Auth mint the session afterwards. That is what was built.

What was wrong

Better Auth's `phoneNumber` plugin wrote the code into `verification.value` as `<code>:<attempts>`, in the clear. Anyone who could read that table — a backup, a replica, a leaked dump, a support tool, an SQL-injection foothold — could sign in as any user with a code in flight.

The one thing that made this harder than a config change

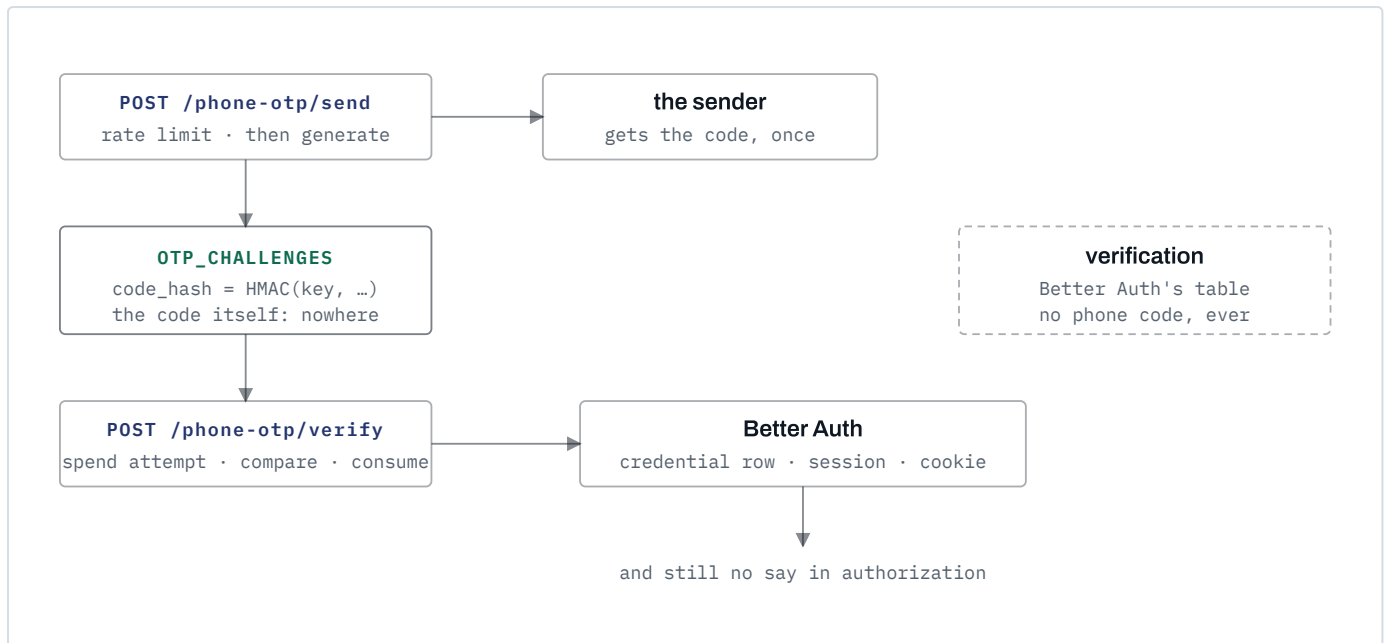
The plugin has a `verifyOTP` hook, so verification could have been delegated to us while leaving the plugin mounted. That would not have been enough: its `send` route writes the plaintext row before it ever calls the sender, and there is no hook on that path. Declining to call the route would have left `POST /api/auth/phone-number/send-otp` reachable by anyone, minting plaintext codes on demand.

So the plugin is not installed at all. Removing it removes the endpoint:

```
$ curl -o /dev/null -w '%{http_code}\n' -X POST \
  localhost:3000/api/auth/phone-number/send-otp -d '{"phoneNumber":"+227..."}'
404
```

What replaced it

An Afrinext plugin with two endpoints, `/phone-otp/send` and `/phone-otp/verify`, served through the same auth handler so they keep the same origin checks and cookie handling. Between them sits `otp-store.ts`, and beneath that the pure functions that were already there and already tested.



The sender is the only thing that ever holds the code, and it holds it once. Everything downstream works from the keyed hash. Better Auth is handed a verified phone number and asked for a session — which is the **whole** of its remaining job.

Why a hash was not enough on its own

THIS IS THE PART WORTH ARGUING WITH ME ABOUT

Your requirement said "only `code_hash` is persisted". The table already had that column, and Phase 0 filled it with a **salted SHA-256**. That would have satisfied the letter of the requirement and still been broken: a six-digit code carries about twenty bits of entropy, so an attacker holding the table and the phone number tries all 1 000 000 candidates in milliseconds. Salting stops a shared rainbow table. It does not stop a loop.

So the hash is now **HMAC-SHA256 under a key derived from the application secret** by HKDF, with its own domain label so it is never the same bytes as the session secret. The key is the one thing a stolen database does not contain. Rotating the secret invalidates only codes with under five minutes to live.

I made this change without asking because I read it as the difference between satisfying the decision and delivering it. If you disagree that it was in scope, that is the one judgement call in this phase I would most want corrected.

Three properties the database enforces, not this code

PROPERTY	HOW	WHAT IT STOPS
One live challenge per identifier and purpose	Partial unique index <code>where consumed_at is null</code>	Banking several codes and spending each one's attempt budget — 5 guesses becomes 25
The attempt counter	<code>update ... where attempts < max_attempts returning</code>	Two simultaneous guesses both reading "4 used" and both proceeding
Single use	<code>update ... where consumed_at is null returning</code>	Several requests presenting the same correct code all getting a session

Each of those was written in SQL rather than TypeScript for the same reason the ledger invariants were: a read-then-write that two requests interleave is not a control, and a future service in another language would have to reimplement it correctly.

What every failure says

Wrong code, expired code, exhausted attempts, and "no such challenge" all return an identical 400 `auth.otp_invalid`. "This number has a code in flight" is itself worth hiding, so the endpoint cannot be used to work out which numbers have accounts. The real reason goes to the audit log, where only we can read it. **TESTED** — the two responses are compared field by field.

Two things this surfaced

FOUND	WHY IT HAD BEEN INVISIBLE	DONE
<code>ConsoleSender</code> never wrote anything — it only recorded messages in memory	Local sign-in worked <i>solely</i> because the code could be read out of Better Auth's plaintext column. Removing that broke development sign-in, which is how the gap showed up.	It now prints, behind the same explicit <code>ALLOW_CONSOLE_SENDER=yes</code> opt-in, announcing that nothing was delivered.
The email OTP plugin also defaulted to plaintext	Not the launch path, so it was out of the decision's scope.	Set to <code>storeOTP: "hashed"</code> . It is the option the phone plugin does not have; leaving it would have been the same defect on a quieter road.

Your eight decisions, and what each became

#	YOUR RULING	WHAT IT BECAME	STATE
1	Plaintext phone OTP — reject (a) and (c), approve (b)	Section 2 in full. Codes are in <code>otp_challenges</code> as a keyed hash; Better Auth's phone plugin is uninstalled and its endpoints 404; expiry, attempt count, phone binding and rate limits all still enforced; Better Auth mints the session; the authorization boundary is untouched.	DONE • TESTED
2	Browser CI tests — approved for Phase 2, minimum three only	Not built. It is Phase 2 work and Phase 2 is not authorised, so it is the first item in section 20 rather than something I started.	SCHEDULED
3	Step-up — mandatory for withdrawals, payout details, phone changes, and any admin action that changes where funds are paid	Written into <code>AGENTS.md</code> as a non-negotiable rule, so it binds the code that gets written rather than living in a document nobody re-reads. The mechanism exists and is tested. No payout logic was implemented — you said not to unless Phase 2 is authorised.	RECORDED • ENFORCEMENT LANDS WITH THE PAYOUT PATH
4	Commission — architecture approved; rates are demonstration values, not pricing	Architecture unchanged. The seeded rates are now labelled in the decision index and in this packet as placeholders that must be confirmed before the first real sale. Nothing treats them as commercial pricing.	DONE

#	YOUR RULING	WHAT IT BECAME	STATE
5	Referral — single level, from realized platform commission only, never exceeding it	Already how the engine works: the line is declared <code>basis: { line: "platform" }</code> with <code>deductFrom: "platform"</code> , so it is arithmetically incapable of touching gross or the seller's share, and bounded by the commission because it is a proportion of it.	DONE • TESTED
6	Session — 30 days, daily refresh, revocable, step-up for financial operations	Unchanged; this is what was already built and you approved it as built.	DONE • TESTED
7	OTP limits — approved for now, keep configurable, document the per-IP limit as a tuning point	The limits moved out of the code. They are a <code>platform_settings</code> row read by <code>loadOtpPolicy()</code> ; the reviewed values are the fallback. A malformed row falls back <i>field by field</i> , so a bad edit can never widen or disable a limit. The per-IP caveat is written into the setting's own description, the decision index and section 8.	DONE • TESTED
8	SMS provider — no selection from a web search; a real Niger handset test decides; keep the adapter swappable; collect the listed facts for three named candidates	Section 18 and <code>docs/providers/sms/README.md</code> : every fact you listed, as a per-candidate collection sheet, plus the delivery test that decides. It contains no claims about any provider , because none has been verified. No adapter written. No provider selected.	REQUIREMENTS DELIVERED • INVESTIGATION NOT STARTED

AND THE FOUR INSTRUCTIONS THAT WERE PROHIBITIONS

No Phase 2 code. No iPayMoney integration and no invented endpoints — the adapter still throws and three tests stay skipped. The ledger was neither weakened nor rebuilt: its files are untouched by this work, and reconciliation still nets to zero. The authorization model is unchanged, and authentication still decides nothing.

What GitHub CI proved

Every run executes: create the test database · migrate · **drop the schema and rebuild it from zero** · seed · `pnpm lint` · `pnpm typecheck` · `pnpm test` · build the web app · **ledger concurrency and idempotency under parallel load** · **assert the ledger reconciles after the suite**; and in a second job, `pnpm audit --audit-level high` as a blocking gate with the full advisory report uploaded as a downloadable artifact.

CI runs on a clean Ubuntu runner against a `postgres:16` service container, installing from a frozen lockfile. Nothing on my workstation is involved.

RUN	COMMIT	WHAT IT COVERS	RESULT
#7	aee5b4c	Security documentation and the SMS procurement bar	SUCCESS
#6	06c9a23	The OTP correction. This is the run that matters.	SUCCESS attempt 2
#5	01d8502	The superseded packet	SUCCESS
#4	fc61db	429 instead of 500 on a refused code	SUCCESS
#3	5cbbac5	Phase 1 as first delivered	SUCCESS
#2	ee04b8f	Phase 0 packet correction	SUCCESS
#1	87743b6	Phase 0	SUCCESS

WHY RUN #6 SAYS "ATTEMPT 2"

The workflow cancels an in-progress run when a newer commit is pushed to the same branch. The documentation commit landed while run #6 was still going, so its first attempt was **cancelled** — not failed, and not passed. Rather than let the correction commit carry no result of its own, I re-ran it. Attempt 2 completed with both jobs green across all sixteen steps, including the rebuild from zero, the concurrency suite and the reconciliation gate.

Run #7 on the head commit covers the same code plus the documentation, so the correction is green twice over on two separate runners.

What only my workstation proved

Executed, quoted in this packet, and **not** in CI. Treat as one person's observation on one machine, reproducible with section 15.

CLAIM	HOW	IN CI?
The old plaintext endpoint returns 404	<code>curl</code> against a production build	THE EQUIVALENT ASSERTION IS: NO SUCH METHOD ON <code>AUTH.API</code>
<code>otp_challenges</code> holds a 64-character hash and <code>verification</code> holds nothing	<code>psql</code> during a real browser sign-in	YES – ASSERTED IN THE SUITE TOO
HTTP status codes on the v1 routes (401 / 403 / 200)	<code>curl</code> and a Playwright request context	NO
Rate-limit refusal is a live 429 with <code>Retry-After</code>	<code>curl -D-</code>	STATUS ASSERTED IN A UNIT TEST; THE HTTP ROUND TRIP IS NOT
The sign-in → code → wallet journey renders	Playwright driving the real UI	NO

STILL TRUE, AND NOW SCHEDULED

There is **no browser test in CI**. Every HTTP and UI claim rests on me having run it on this commit. Your decision 2 fixes exactly this, and it is the first item of Phase 2.

Phase 1 in total is four commits on `claude/create-app-repository-1cxsih`. The last two are the correction you asked for.

COMMIT	WHAT IT IS	SCALE
aee5b4c	Security documentation and the SMS procurement bar	4 files, docs only
06c9a23	Move phone OTP back to our own hashed table	15 files · +1 079 / -80
fc61db	Return 429, not 500, when OTP issuance is refused	2 files
5cbbac5	Phase 1 as first delivered	54 files · +10 993 / -1 078

The correction, file by file — read these

FILE	LINES	WHAT TO LOOK AT
auth/phone-otp.test.ts	413	New. The adversarial suite. Start here — it states every property the rest of the change is supposed to have.
auth/phone-otp-plugin.ts	235	New. The two endpoints, the identical-failure response, and the comment explaining why Better Auth's plugin is not mounted.
auth/otp-store.ts	170	New. The three SQL statements that carry the guarantees. This is the security-critical file.
auth/otp.ts	123	Rewritten: HMAC under a derived key instead of a bare digest, and the timing values become configuration.
ratelimit/index.ts	+80	<code>loadOtpPolicy()</code> and the field-by-field fallback that stops a bad settings row widening a limit.
db/migrations/0006_...sql	35	The constraint change, the partial unique index, and the table comment a reviewer will actually find.
auth/better-auth.ts	-1 plugin	The single most important diff line in the change: <code>phoneNumber</code> is gone from the plugin list.
auth/messaging.ts	+20	<code>ConsoleSender</code> finally emits what it claims to.
web/lib/auth-client.ts	37	Two thin helpers over the new endpoints; the phone client plugin is gone with the server one.

Package source is now 4 763 lines against 2 634 lines of tests — a ratio of about 0.55, concentrated on money, authorization and now one-time codes.

Read from a live PostgreSQL 16 after applying all seven migrations, on a schema that was dropped and rebuilt from zero first:

OBJECT	COUNT	NOTE
Tables	28	24 ours, 4 Better Auth's — all declared in our schema. Unchanged by the correction.
Migrations	7	0006 is new. All seven replay from zero in CI.
Triggers enforcing invariants	9	Unchanged — the ledger was not touched.
Named check constraints	18	otp_purpose_step_up_only became otp_purpose_valid ; the count is unchanged.
Partial unique indexes	1	otp_one_live_challenge — new, and load-bearing.
Platform settings	9	Was 8. auth.otp_policy is the new one.

Migration 0006

```
-- 'sign_in' was forbidden while Better Auth owned the flow. It is ours again.
ALTER TABLE otp_challenges DROP CONSTRAINT IF EXISTS otp_purpose_step_up_only;
ALTER TABLE otp_challenges
  ADD CONSTRAINT otp_purpose_valid
  CHECK (purpose IN ('sign_in', 'verify_identity', 'step_up'));

-- One live challenge per identifier and purpose. Enforced here rather than in
-- application code because the alternative is a read-then-write that two
-- simultaneous requests interleave: both see no live challenge, both insert,
-- and the caller ends up holding two codes with a full attempt budget each.
CREATE UNIQUE INDEX otp_one_live_challenge
  ON otp_challenges (kind, identifier, purpose)
  WHERE consumed_at IS NULL;
```

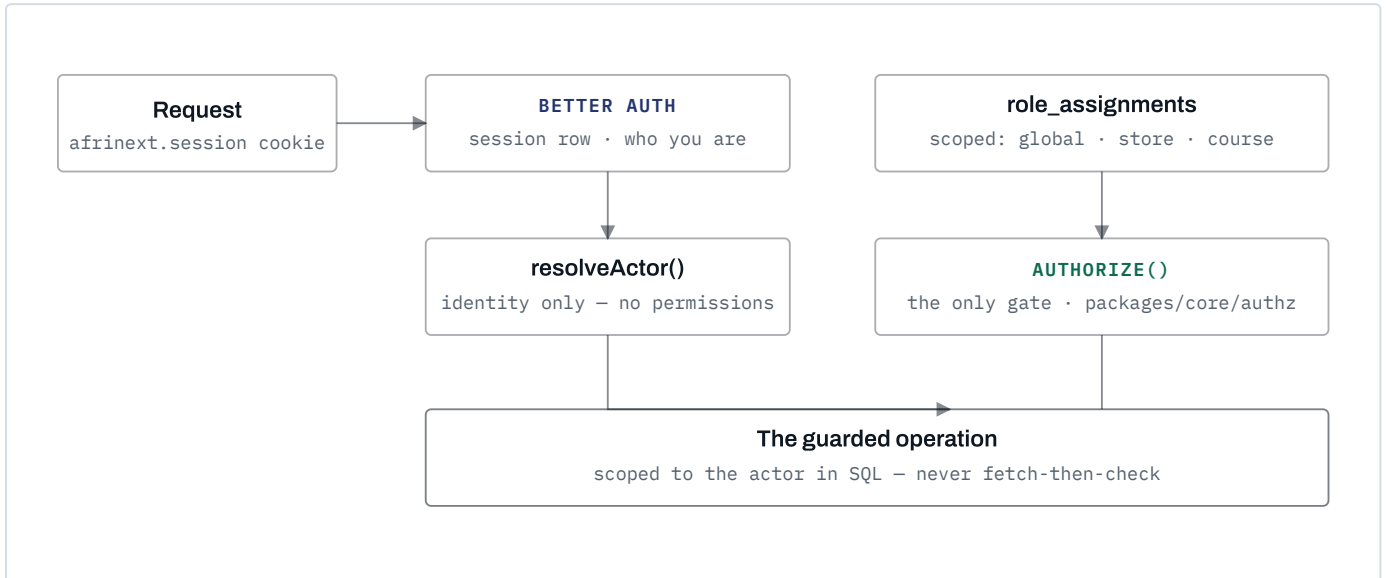
Plus a table comment recording what `code_hash` is and why, and the `auth.otp_policy` settings row. The migration is idempotent on the constraint drop, so it applies to a database that already went through Phase 1 as well as to one built from zero. **TESTED** — both paths were run.

ONE THING A REVIEWER SHOULD CHECK ME ON

0006 has no drizzle-kit snapshot, the same as 0001 and 0005 : it is hand-written SQL for constraints, indexes and comments, which drizzle-kit does not model. It applies and replays correctly — CI proves that on every run by rebuilding from zero — but it will not appear in a generated diff. If you would rather every migration be generated, say so and I will restructure how the invariant migrations are produced.

Authentication — and the line it does not cross

Your instruction was that authentication must not become authorization, and that the correction must preserve that boundary. It does, and the boundary is easier to see now than before: Better Auth's remaining job is smaller.



Better Auth answers exactly one question: **who is this?** It has no path to the right-hand column. A session it considers perfectly valid still yields nothing but a user id, and every capability is a separate lookup against scoped role assignments.

What the correction did and did not move

CONCERN	BEFORE	NOW
Generating and storing the code	Better Auth, in plaintext	Ours, as a keyed hash
Rate limiting issuance	Ours	Ours — unchanged
Bounding attempts	Better Auth	Ours, in SQL
Expiry and single use	Better Auth	Ours, in SQL
The credential row	Better Auth	Better Auth — unchanged, and still what fires the hook that provisions the Afrinext identity
The session	Better Auth	Better Auth — unchanged, and still the only session store
Permissions	authorize()	authorize() — untouched by this work

No second session store was introduced, which you specifically prohibited: `session` remains the only one, and the new verify endpoint asks Better Auth for a session rather than minting anything itself.

Drift detection still applies

Better Auth's four tables are still declared by us and created by our migrations, and `schema-drift.test.ts` still fails the build if its expectations diverge from what we declare. Removing the phone plugin changed which fields it expects; the drift test passes against the new set, which is how I know the plugin's schema contribution was replaced correctly rather than merely deleted. **TESTED** — 4 tests.

Where a verification code can exist

PLACE	HOLDS THE CODE?
<code>otp_challenges.code_hash</code>	A keyed hash of it. THE ONLY RECORD
The sender, once, in memory, on its way out	Yes — unavoidable, it has to be delivered
Better Auth's <code>verification</code>	NEVER — asserted by test and by the absent plugin
Audit log	NEVER — the reason is recorded, the code is not
Application logs	NEVER — and the structured logger redacts by key name recursively
The HTTP response	NEVER — verify returns a status and a session token, nothing else

OTP issuance is limited, not just attempts

Unchanged in substance, now read from `platform_settings` :

RULE	LIMIT	WINDOW
Codes per identifier	5	1 hour
Cooldown between codes	1	60 seconds
Codes per IP	20	1 hour
Step-up challenges per user	3	1 hour
Verification attempts per code	5	per challenge, in SQL

Together those bound guessing at **25 attempts per phone per hour** against a million-value space, and the attempt budget is spent by wrong guesses whether or not they land.

THE PRODUCTION-TUNING POINT, AS YOU ASKED

The **per-IP limit of 20 per hour** is the number to watch. Carrier NAT and shared connections are the norm in Niger, so a whole neighbourhood can sit behind one address and hit that limit legitimately. It is a `platform_settings` row — changing it is an UPDATE, not a deploy — and the caveat is written into the setting's own description so whoever finds it in the admin console reads the reason.

A refusal is a 429, an invalid code is a 400

```
$ curl -D- -X POST localhost:3000/api/auth/phone-otp/send \
      -H 'content-type: application/json' -d '{"phoneNumber":"+22790..."}'
HTTP/1.1 200 OK

- immediately again -
HTTP/1.1 429 TOO_MANY_REQUESTS
retry-after: 2
{"code":"ratelimit.exceeded","message":"Too many verification code requests. Try again in 2 second(s"}
```

An unrecognised throw out of a Better Auth callback becomes a bare 500, which tells the caller nothing and reads as our fault in monitoring. Both the rate-limit refusal and the invalid-code response are deliberate, asserted statuses.

Passwords

Unchanged: Afrinext's scrypt, parameters encoded in each hash so a later move to Argon2id can verify old hashes while writing new ones.

UNTOUCHED BY THE CORRECTION

The ledger, the money primitives and the commission engine have no diff in `06c9a23`. You said not to weaken or rebuild the ledger; the honest evidence for that is that its files do not appear in the change at all, and the reconciliation gate still runs clean.

Commissions are configuration, resolved by rule

No rate is a constant anywhere. A rule may name a country, a category, a store, or none, and resolution is most-specific-first with a total order so the same inputs always give the same answer and a settlement can be re-derived years later. If no rule is in force, `freezeSchedule` **throws** rather than defaulting.

DECISION 4, RECORDED WHERE IT WILL BE SEEN

The seeded rates — **18 % course and digital**, **15 % service**, **12 % physical** — are demonstration and configuration values. They are *not* commercial pricing and must be explicitly confirmed before the first real sale. They will be in the database from that sale onward, so the confirmation is a real gate, not a formality.

Referral, as ruled

Single level. A referral line is declared `basis: { line: "platform" }` with `deductFrom: "platform"`, so it is *arithmetically incapable* of touching the gross customer payment or the seller's entitlement, and it cannot exceed the commission because it is a proportion of it. Nothing pays for registration or recruitment — there is no code path that would.

The residual rule

Every non-seller line rounds half-up; the seller receives `gross - Σ(other lines)`, absorbing the remainder so the split always re-sums exactly. In XOF this is not academic: **zero decimals** means the minor unit is the franc, and a one-unit rounding error is a franc that either exists or does not.

The reconciliation gate, run on this commit

```
{
  "scenario": { "gross": "10000", "seller": "8200",
               "platform": "1620", "referral": "180" },
  "checkedAccounts": 8,
  "drift": 0,
  "unbalancedTransactions": 0,
  "netByCurrency": { "XOF": "0" }
}
```

Ledger reconciliation clean over a real capture → settlement → payout cycle.

10 000 XOF at 18 % gives the platform 1 800, of which a 10 % referral takes 180, leaving 1 620 — and the seller 8 200, unchanged by the referral existing. **TESTED** in CI as the last step of every run.

Still deliberately absent

No screen, field, API response or column calls a seller balance a deposit or protected funds.

`/api/v1/wallet` says so in the payload itself: "Balances are contractual entitlements against Afrinext, not deposits."

172 passed, 3 skipped, across 16 files — up from 146 across 15. Executed on this commit, locally and on GitHub CI. The three skipped are the iPayMoney integration tests, skipped because there is nothing to integrate against, and never folded into the passing number.

FILE	TESTS	WHAT IT PROVES
auth/phone-otp.test.ts	23	New. The correction, adversarially. Section 11.
auth/auth.test.ts	22	Passwords, and the OTP primitives — now including that a wrong key verifies nothing, and that the last permitted attempt still works.
ledger/ledger.test.ts	14	Double-entry invariants, append-only, currency matching, idempotency.
ratelimit/ratelimit.test.ts	14	Windows, cooldowns, per-IP rules, and that concurrent consumers cannot overshoot.
commissions/commissions.test.ts	13	Rule specificity, deterministic tie-breaks, frozen snapshots, refusal with no rule.
money/money.test.ts	13	Minor units, zero-decimal currencies, refusal of floats. Property-based.
payments/payments.test.ts	13	The provider abstraction; the mock refusing to load in production.
auth/flow.test.ts	11	Phone sign-in end to end on the new endpoints, provisioning, revocation, elevation, the 429.
authz/authorize.test.ts	11	Scoped permissions, denial by default, suspended users.
money/allocate.test.ts	9	The residual rule. Property-based.
money/currency.test.ts	7	Exponents read from the table, not assumed to be 2.
ledger/concurrency.test.ts	6	Parallel posting, lost updates, idempotency under races. Found the deadlock.
consent/consent.test.ts	6	Versioned documents, append-only consent records.
observability/logger.test.ts	5	Recursive secret redaction by key name.
auth/schema-drift.test.ts	4	Our declared Better Auth tables still match what Better Auth expects.
payments/ipaymoney.integration.test.ts	4	1 asserts the adapter refuses to pretend. 3 skipped.

11 Testing the tests

You asked for the correction to be tested **adversarially**. Twenty-three tests that all pass proves nothing on its own — a test can assert a property it does not actually exercise. So each critical guarantee was broken on purpose to see whether its test noticed.

#	DELIBERATE DEFECT	CAUGHT BY	FIRST ATTEMPT
1	Consumption stops being conditional — drop <code>and consumed_at is null</code>	2 tests	NOT CAUGHT
2	The attempt counter stops being bounded — drop <code>and attempts < max_attempts</code>	1 test	NOT CAUGHT CLEANLY
3	Store the code instead of its hash	7 tests	CAUGHT
4	Re-mount Better Auth's plaintext phone plugin	1 test	CAUGHT

TWO OF THE FOUR SLIPPED THROUGH, AND WHY THAT MATTERS MORE THAN THE TWO THAT DID NOT

Mutation 1 passed because the test signed in a *new* phone number each time, so the unique constraint on the credential row rejected the duplicate sessions. The test was passing on the strength of a completely different mechanism. Fixed by adding two tests: one below the endpoint entirely, where nothing else can intervene, and one for a phone that already has a credential.

Mutation 2 was "caught" only in the sense that something threw — but what threw was the check constraint, producing a 500 rather than the clean 400 the real code returns. The test asserted "rejects", which both behaviours satisfy. Fixed by asserting the status and the error code, which distinguishes a refusal from a crash.

Both fixes were verified by re-running the same mutation and watching the test fail. If I had stopped at "23 tests, all green", the packet would have claimed a guarantee that one of its two central tests was not actually checking.

The mutations are not committed — they were applied, run, and reverted. Section 15 shows you how to reproduce any of them in about a minute.

Carried forward from the first issue of this packet, because it remains the most valuable thing the phase produced and nothing about it changed.

`postTransaction` updated cached balance rows in whatever order the entries happened to be written, so a transfer A → B locked A then B while a concurrent B → A locked B then A. Each held what the other wanted; PostgreSQL aborted one with a deadlock. Under a real marketplace this is not exotic — two buyers paying two sellers who also trade with each other is enough — and it would have appeared as intermittent, unreproducible payment failures.

```
// Sorting by account id means every transaction in the system acquires these
// locks in the same order, which makes such a cycle impossible. Found by the
// concurrent-posting test, not by reasoning.
const orderedDelta = [...delta].sort(([a], [b]) => (a < b ? -1 : a > b ? 1 : 0));
```

CONCURRENCY SUITE	BEFORE	AFTER
Wall time		23 s 0.9 s
Outcome	deadlock aborts, retries	clean

The rule is in `AGENTS.md`: anything that locks more than one row sorts first. The suite runs as its own named CI step, so a regression is attributable rather than buried in a 175-test summary.

```
$ pnpm audit --audit-level high  
No known vulnerabilities found
```

Executed on this commit, locally and in CI. No dependency was added or removed by the correction — the new code uses `node:crypto`, Drizzle and Better Auth's own plugin API, all already present. Removing the phone plugin removed code from the build without removing a package.

PACKAGE	SEVERITY	ISSUE	RESOLUTION
drizzle-orm	HIGH	CVE-2026-39356 — SQL injection through identifiers	Upgraded to 0.45.2 during Phase 1. Drizzle stays, per your decision; only the version moved.
vitest	CRITICAL	Advisory in the pinned range	Upgraded to 3.2.7.
vite / esbuild	TRANSITIVE	Pulled in below the patched versions	Pinned by root <code>overrides</code> .

Better Auth stays pinned at exactly `1.7.1`. That matters more after this change than before: an upgrade that re-introduced the phone plugin would reintroduce plaintext storage. The suite now fails if those endpoints ever exist again, so the upgrade cannot pass silently.

Produced against a production build (`next build` then `next start`) on this commit. None of it is in CI — see section 4.

The plaintext path is gone

```
$ curl -o /dev/null -w '%{http_code}'
  -X POST      localhost:3000/api/auth/phone-number/send-otp -d '{"phoneNumber":"+22790..."}'
404
```

```
$ curl -X POST localhost:3000/api/auth/phone-otp/send -d '{"phoneNumber":"+22790..."}'
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
```

```
– and what the database then holds, read with psql during the sign-in –
otp_challenges: aff4fed72107b9e88ef89bcb5aab8e00c39e4ee09e3161373b82eb794add21b1
verification rows for this phone: 0
```

Sixty-four hex characters and no row on the other side. After a successful verification the challenge reads `consumed_at is not null` , so the same code cannot be presented again.

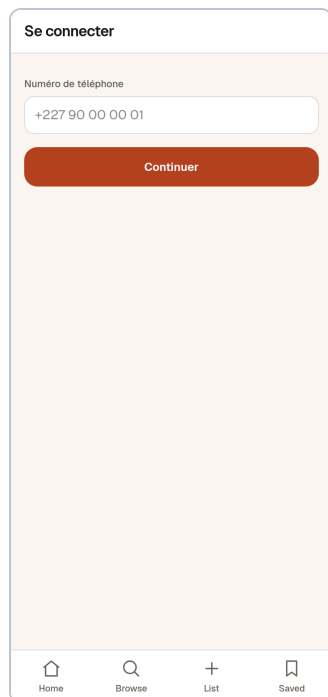
HTTP behaviour

ROUTE	ANONYMOUS	SIGNED-IN MEMBER	READING
/api/v1/me	401	200	Returns the identity and its permission list.
/api/v1/wallet	401	200	Entitlements derived from ledger entries, not from the cache.
/api/v1/admin/ledger	401	403	The one that matters. Authentication fully succeeded; it grants nothing.
/api/auth/phone-otp/send	200 then 429	–	Second immediate request refused with <code>Retry-After</code> .
/api/auth/phone-number/send-otp	404	404	The removed plaintext endpoint.

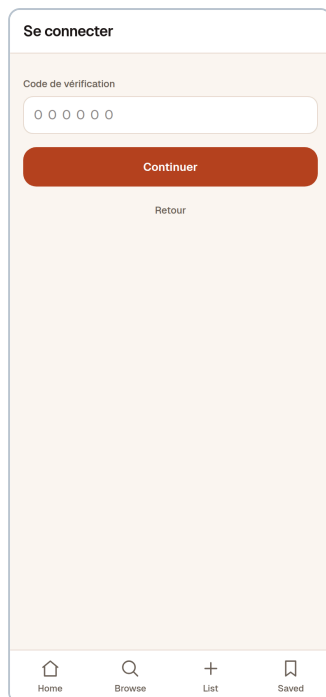
```
– signed-in member, admin route –
{"error":{"code":"authz.denied",
  "message":"Permission "ledger.read" is not granted on global."}}
```

The journey, end to end

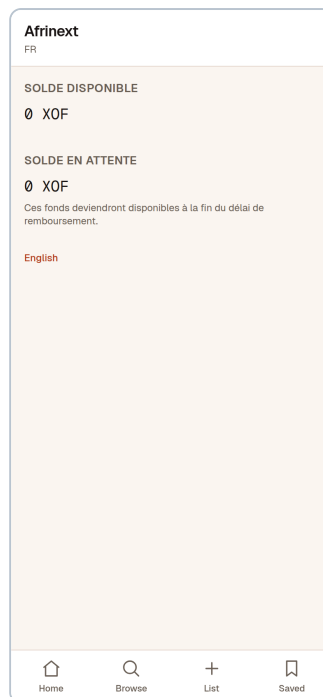
Driven by a real browser at 390×844 — the phone this is built for, not a desktop window narrowed down. Every step runs on the new endpoints.



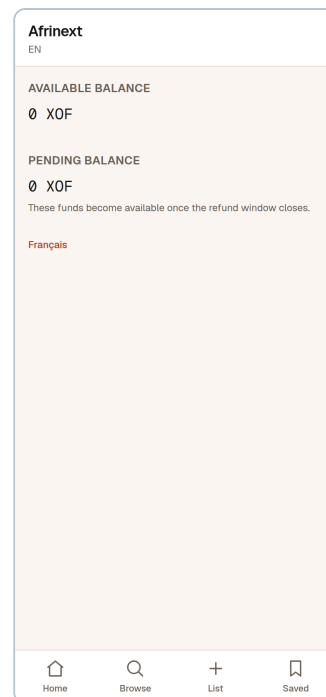
Sign in — The phone step, French by default because Niger's default locale is a row in the `locales` table, not a constant.



Verification code — The six-digit step. The code reached the handset — here, the console — and exists nowhere else in readable form.



Wallet • FR — 0 XOF, not **0,00 XOF** — the exponent came from the `currencies` table. Nothing on this screen calls the balance a deposit.



Wallet • EN — The same route under `/en`. Locale is a path segment, so both are linkable and an unknown locale 404s rather than falling back.

15 Reproduce every claim

Node 22+, pnpm 10+, PostgreSQL 16+. Nothing here needs my machine.

1 Get the branch and install

```
git clone https://github.com/abdoulasani/Afrinext
cd Afrinext && git checkout claude/create-app-repository-1cxsih
git log --oneline -4          # aee5b4c, 06c9a23, fcb61db, 5cbbac5
pnpm install --frozen-lockfile
```

2 Two databases, then build the schema

```
cp .env.example .env          # DATABASE_URL and TEST_DATABASE_URL must differ
pnpm db:migrate
pnpm --filter @afrinext/core seed
```

3 Run everything

```
pnpm lint                    # exits 0
pnpm typecheck               # exits 0
pnpm test                    # 172 passed | 3 skipped (175), 16 files
pnpm build                   # exits 0
pnpm audit --audit-level high # No known vulnerabilities found
```

4 Read the correction on its own

```
git show 06c9a23 --stat
pnpm --filter @afrinext/core exec vitest run src/auth/phone-otp.test.ts
```

23 tests. The file is written to be read top to bottom as a statement of what must be true.

5 Break it on purpose and watch a test fail

Any one of these takes under a minute. Revert with `git checkout` afterwards.

```
# In packages/core/src/auth/otp-store.ts:
#   · delete "and consumed_at is null" from the consuming UPDATE → 2 tests fail
#   · delete "and attempts < max_attempts"                      → 1 test fails
#   · store ${otp.code} instead of ${otp.codeHash}              → 7 tests fail
# In packages/core/src/auth/better-auth.ts:
#   · re-add phoneNumber() to the plugin list                    → 1 test fails
pnpm --filter @afrinext/core exec vitest run src/auth/phone-otp.test.ts
```

6 See the deadlock the concurrency tests found

Remove the `.sort(...)` in `packages/core/src/ledger/post.ts` and re-run `src/ledger/concurrency.test.ts`: under a second becomes roughly twenty-three, with deadlock aborts in the output.

7 Prove the ledger separately

```
DATABASE_URL="$TEST_DATABASE_URL" \  
pnpm --filter @afrinext/core exec tsx scripts/reconcile-check.ts
```

`drift` must be 0 and every currency must net to 0.

8 Check the plaintext claim yourself

```
ALLOW_CONSOLE_SENDER=yes pnpm start  
  
curl -o /dev/null -w '%{http_code}\n' -X POST \  
  localhost:3000/api/auth/phone-number/send-otp -d '{"phoneNumber":"+22790000001"}'  
# 404 – the plaintext endpoint no longer exists  
  
curl -X POST localhost:3000/api/auth/phone-otp/send \  
  -H 'content-type: application/json' -d '{"phoneNumber":"+22790000001"}'  
# then, in psql:  
#   select code_hash from otp_challenges where identifier = '+22790000001';  
#   select * from verification where identifier = '+22790000001';   -- empty
```

The code is printed by `ConsoleSender` in the server output; there is nowhere else to read it.

9 Read the CI runs rather than trusting this document

github.com/abdoulasani/Afrinext/actions — every step name is visible, and the dependency-scan job attaches its full advisory report to every run.

Built, but not tested

THING	STATUS	WHAT THAT MEANS FOR YOU
Step-up guarding an actual payout	NOT TESTED	The mechanism has tests and decision 3 now names exactly which actions must demand it. Nothing yet <i>calls</i> it before moving money, because no payout endpoint exists — and you said not to build one.
Every HTTP route handler	NOT TESTED	No automated test hits a route. The status codes in section 14 came from me running <code>curl</code> once. Decision 2 closes the part of this that matters.
Every React component	NOT TESTED	<code>apps/web</code> has no test suite. <code>pnpm test</code> there prints a placeholder and exits 0.
Email OTP delivery	NOT TESTED	Configured and now hashed at rest, but nothing sends an email and phone is the launch path.
Challenge pruning on a schedule	NOT SCHEDULED	<code>pruneChallenges()</code> exists and is tested, but nothing calls it periodically. Spent rows accumulate until something does.
The consent flow in the UI	NOT TESTED	Tables and core functions are tested. No screen presents a document or records agreement.

Not built

THING	STATUS	NOTE
SMS delivery to a real handset	NOT IMPLEMENTED	No provider chosen, contracted or coded. Section 18. This is why nobody outside the repository can sign in.
iPayMoney integration	NOT IMPLEMENTED	The adapter throws. No invented endpoints, authentication parameters, webhook payloads or success responses. 13 documentation items are listed in <code>docs/providers/ipaymoney/README.md</code> .
Payouts and withdrawals	NOT IMPLEMENTED	The four-eyes rule is designed and has a place in the schema. No endpoint exists to enforce it on, and you instructed that none be built yet.
Browser tests in CI	NOT IMPLEMENTED	Approved for Phase 2, three assertions only.
Products, orders, checkout, courses	NOT IMPLEMENTED	Phase 2 and beyond.

CLOSED SINCE THE LAST PACKET

Risk 1 — plaintext verification codes. Resolved by the correction. Codes exist only as a keyed hash; Better Auth's plaintext path is uninstalled and its endpoint 404s; four deliberate defects were introduced and each was caught by a test.

Risk 3 — a refused request still wrote a code row. Also gone: we now generate the code ourselves, *after* the rate-limit check, so a refused request writes nothing at all.

RISK A — NO BROWSER TEST IN CI

Unchanged. The 403 on the admin route is the most security-relevant behaviour in the running application and its only proof is that I ran it by hand. A refactor that broke it would ship green. Decision 2 addresses it in Phase 2.

RISK B — THE OTP KEY SHARES A LIFECYCLE WITH THE SESSION SECRET

The hashing key is derived from `SESSION_SECRET` by HKDF with its own domain label, so the two are never the same bytes. But they rotate together: changing the session secret invalidates every OTP in flight. With a five-minute TTL that is a handful of people retrying, which is why it was chosen over a second secret to manage. If you would rather have an independent `OTP_PEPPER`, it is a small change and now is the time.

RISK C — SPENT CHALLENGES ARE NOT PRUNED AUTOMATICALLY

A consumed or expired row holds no live secret, but it does record who asked for a code and when. `pruneChallenges()` exists and is tested; nothing schedules it. Left unscheduled, `otp_challenges` slowly becomes a contact-and-activity log nobody asked for.

RISK D — THE RATE LIMITER IS INSTANCE-AGNOSTIC BUT NOT INSTANCE-TESTED

Counters live in PostgreSQL and increment atomically, so limits hold across instances by construction. That is tested with concurrent callers against one database; it has never run against two application processes, because there has never been more than one.

RISK E — REGULATORY POSTURE IS UNCHANGED AND UNRESOLVED

NIF and RCCM establish company registration. They do not establish authorization for regulated payment activity, and consent does not substitute for authorization. Nothing in this phase changes that, and no screen implies otherwise. It remains outside engineering's control.

RISK F – NO SMS PROVIDER, SO NO REAL USERS

Not a code risk; a launch risk, and the largest one open. Section 18.

SMS procurement — the requirements, not an answer

NOTHING IS SELECTED, AND NOTHING BELOW IS A CLAIM ABOUT ANY PROVIDER

You said a provider must not be chosen from a web search, and that a real Niger handset test decides. So this section and [docs/providers/sms/README.md](#) contain **no coverage claims, no pricing, and no recommendation**. They are the collection sheet and the test. Filling them in requires answers from the providers and a SIM in Niger — neither of which I can produce from here, and inventing either would be exactly the failure mode you have ruled out twice.

The test that actually decides

#	CHECK	PASSES WHEN
1	Airtel Niger delivery	A code arrives on an Airtel SIM in Niger
2	Orange Niger delivery	A code arrives on an Orange SIM in Niger
3	Moov Niger delivery	A code arrives on a Moov SIM in Niger
4	Latency	Fast enough that someone waiting on the sign-in screen does not give up — measured, not assumed
5	Repeatability	Across a day, including evening peak — not one lucky send
6	Sender identity	The handset shows the registered sender, not a rotating shortcode

A provider that cannot demonstrate all three networks is not a candidate, whatever its documentation says.

What must be collected per candidate

GROUP	ITEMS
Coverage & routing	Niger coverage · Airtel · Orange · Moov · transactional/OTP routing separate from marketing · whether traffic is aggregated through a third party, and which
Sender identity	Sender ID requirements for Niger · registration process, documents and lead time · whether alphanumeric sender IDs are permitted · what the recipient actually sees
Operational	Delivery reports and their granularity · webhook support and its authentication · retry behaviour and whether it is configurable · provider-side rate limits · test/sandbox availability and whether it proves <i>real</i> delivery
Commercial	Price per SMS to Niger, per network if it differs · minimum balance or commitment · account and company requirements, including whether an Entreprise Individuelle in Niger is eligible · billing currency · SLA and support hours, channels and response times
API & security	API authentication method · documentation public, complete and current · data and security terms: where message content is stored, for how long, and who can read it

First investigation

Three candidates, as you named them, in no order and with none preferred: **SawkiWebSMS**, **EasySendSMS**, **Twilio**. The output is one filled-in sheet each plus the delivery-test result. Selection happens after that, not before.

What engineering has already done, so the choice stays cheap

- `MessageSender` has two methods and no provider concepts. An adapter implements those two and nothing else.
- Nothing in the OTP flow knows about a provider. Issuance, rate limiting, hashing, attempt bounds, expiry and consumption all sit above the sender — **swapping providers touches one file and no authentication or OTP business logic**, which is what you required.
- `ConsoleSender` refuses to start in production without an explicit opt-in, so a missing provider fails loudly rather than silently dropping every code.
- Audit records which sender handled each code, so a switch is visible in the record.

TWO CORRECTIONS THIS PACKET CARRIES

One. The Phase 0 packet stated that CI had never run. That was false — it had run and passed twice before I wrote the sentence, and I asserted the pessimistic thing without checking. Corrected in six places in `docs/review/phase-0.html`, and its PDF was regenerated.

Two. The first issue of *this* packet described `fc61db`, run #4 and 146 tests, and you were right that it must not stand as the final state. It has been replaced in place, at the same URL, by this document. The earlier PDF is superseded; if anyone is still holding it, the file to use is the one attached to this issue.

RULE	HELD?	WHERE IT IS ENFORCED RATHER THAN PROMISED
No floating-point arithmetic for money	HELD	<code>bigint</code> minor units plus a currency code; <code>money()</code> rejects a non-integer. Property-tested.
Zero-decimal currencies are not special-cased	HELD	Exponent read from the <code>currencies</code> table. The wallet renders <code>0XOF</code> .
The ledger is append-only and double-entry	HELD	Four database triggers, untouched by this phase's correction.
Do not weaken or rebuild the ledger	HELD	Its files have no diff in <code>06c9a23</code> . Reconciliation still nets to zero.
Never trust frontend validation for financial or permission-sensitive operations	HELD	Every route resolves the actor server-side and calls <code>authorize()</code> . The 403 is issued by the server to a client that asked politely.
Nobody approves their own withdrawal	NOT YET REACHABLE	Designed; no withdrawal endpoint exists, and you instructed that none be built.
Seller balances are never called deposits or protected funds	HELD	Stated in the API payload itself.
Registration is not authorization for regulated activity	HELD	Nothing claims otherwise. Risk E.
Do not invent <code>iPayMoney</code> endpoints, auth, webhooks or responses	HELD	The adapter throws. Three tests stay skipped rather than passing against a fiction.
Do not select or code an SMS provider from a web search	HELD	No adapter written, no provider named as suitable, no coverage or pricing asserted.
Do not claim CI is verified until it has run	HELD	Section 4 lists every run by commit and result, including one that was cancelled.
Never say "verified" unless the test was executed	HELD	Section 1 defines the vocabulary; section 11 shows the tests themselves being tested.
Stop and ask on decisions affecting money, security, auth or data integrity	HELD	Stopped twice in Phase 1. The one judgement I made without asking — keying the hash rather than merely hashing — is flagged in section 2 for you to overrule.
Authentication must not become authorization	HELD	Section 7, including what the correction moved and what it deliberately did not.

RULE	HELD?	WHERE IT IS ENFORCED RATHER THAN PROMISED
Do not introduce another session store	HELD	<code>session</code> is still the only one; the verify endpoint asks Better Auth for a session rather than minting its own.
Do not replace the authorization model or the users/roles schema	HELD	Neither has a diff in this correction.
Do not silently weaken existing controls	HELD	Every control the decision listed is still enforced, and three of them moved from application code into the database.
No Phase 2 code	HELD	Section 20 is a proposal. Nothing in it has been started.

What Phase 2 would be

A PROPOSAL, NOT A PLAN IN MOTION

No Phase 2 work has started and none will start without your explicit approval.

1 The three browser assertions in CI

Decision 2, first because it is cheap and because every subsequent route benefits from it: unauthenticated 401, signed-in member 403 on an admin route, and the sign-in journey completing. Not a UI suite — three assertions that would catch an authorization regression.

2 Stores and products

A seller creates a store and publishes a paid digital product at a public URL. Where the commission engine's `subjectType` / `subjectId` stops being hypothetical.

3 Consent, presented rather than merely stored

Show a document, record the acceptance against its version, and block the actions that require it.

4 Checkout against the mock provider, end to end

Order → capture → `freezeSchedule` → post to the ledger → reconcile. Against the mock, because iPayMoney remains undocumented. The first time the whole spine carries a real order.

5 The payout path, with step-up and four eyes

A withdrawal request, an approval by someone else, and step-up demanded at the moment of approval — on exactly the actions decision 3 names. This is where that decision stops being a rule in a document.

Proposed exit criterion: a buyer purchases a digital product, the seller's entitlement appears in their wallet with the commission frozen and reconciling to zero drift, a withdrawal is requested, and a second person must approve it under step-up — with iPayMoney still absent and still not pretended.

THE THING THAT IS NOT CODE, AND HAS NOT MOVED

An SMS provider for Niger. Without one, nobody outside this repository can sign in, and none of the above can be tested by a real person on a real handset. It has been the top non-engineering blocker since the Phase 0 packet. Section 18 is now everything engineering can contribute to it without a company account and a SIM.

Phase 1 complete, corrections included · branch `claude/create-app-repository-1cxsih` · head `aee5b4c` ·
Phase 2 will not begin without explicit approval.

Afrinext Technical Blueprint

The architecture for a multi-country African commerce and learning platform built around a double-entry ledger — stack, schema, permission model, money design, security controls and a phased build order.

Rev 2 – Phase 0 authorised

Operator: AFRI NEXT TECHNOLOGIE

Launch: Niger · XOF

iPayMoney: not integrated

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- G Learning & video
- H Referral network
- I Delivery
- J API architecture
- K Security
- L Project structure
- M Roadmap
- R Risk register
- P What iPay needs
- S Status register
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The read, and one pushback

Afrinext is three businesses sharing one identity system. A **marketplace** (physical goods, digital goods, services), a **learning platform** (paid video and documents with entitlement), and a **money system** (wallet, commissions, settlement, payouts). Delivery and the referral network are not separate products — they are two more sources of ledger events.

That framing decides the architecture. The ledger is the spine; everything else is a producer of financial events that the ledger records. A course purchase, a delivered parcel and an ambassador commission are the same shape of thing once they reach the money layer. If that layer is designed last, every module above it grows its own private notion of "balance" and the platform becomes unauditable.

The "one person, one account, many roles" principle is right and it is cheap to honour, provided one rule holds from the first migration: **there is no role column on the user**. Roles are rows, they are scoped to a resource, and they are additive.

The pushback

The module list in the brief is a two-to-three-year product. Built as specified — all modules in parallel — every part arrives shallow, and the hardest, least reversible part (money) gets exercised last, by which point the schema is load-bearing for a dozen features.

Launch one vertical: digital products and courses, one country, one payment rail.

WHY	It exercises identity, roles, stores, catalog, checkout, payments, ledger, commissions, wallet, withdrawals, entitlement and protected video — every hard part except logistics — with no inventory, no couriers, no cash handling and near-instant fulfilment. It is the shortest path to a real settled transaction, which is the only thing that proves the platform works.
INSTEAD OF	Launching the full marketplace, delivery network and creator marketplace together.
TRADE-OFF	Physical goods and delivery slip to a second launch, roughly five weeks of work that starts later rather than never. Ambassadors have a thinner catalog to promote at day one.
REVERSIBLE?	Yes. Nothing in this blueprint's schema or module boundaries assumes the narrow scope — the tables for physical goods and delivery are designed here, just not built first.

Confirmed. The staged scope is now fixed as below. The V2 and V3 architecture stays in this document even though it is not being built yet — removing it would only mean rediscovering it later.

SCOPE		STATUS
V1	Identity, authentication, multiple roles, stores, digital products, PDF/ebooks/guides, courses, learning progress, marketplace, checkout, payment integration, ledger, commission engine, seller financial records, payout architecture, Afrinext Network, admin foundation	BUILDING
V2	Physical products, inventory, delivery partners, delivery state machine, proof of delivery	DESIGNED, NOT BUILT
V3	Creator marketplace, advanced services marketplace, further ecosystem functionality	DESIGNED, NOT BUILT

Launch market is Niger, launch currency XOF. Neither is hard-coded: countries and currencies are rows, and the multi-country design elsewhere in this document is unchanged.

What is in the repository today

The current Afrinext repository holds a mobile-first PWA directory prototype: Next.js 16, Tailwind v4, an in-memory listing store, seed data, and a submission form. It is honest about what it is — there is no database, no authentication, no payments, and no money. In this plan:

ASSET	DISPOSITION
Design tokens, PWA shell, mobile navigation, card and form components	CARRIES FORWARD Becomes the seed of <code>packages/ui</code> .
Next.js 16 + TypeScript + Tailwind v4 setup, lint and build config	CARRIES FORWARD Becomes <code>apps/web</code> inside the monorepo.
<code>src/lib/store.ts</code> , <code>src/lib/seed.ts</code> , the in-memory model	DISCARD Replaced by Postgres and Drizzle.
<code>src/lib/search.ts</code> , <code>validate.ts</code> , the URL-driven filter pattern	REWRITE, KEEP THE SHAPE The pattern is right; the implementation moves to the database and to shared Zod schemas.

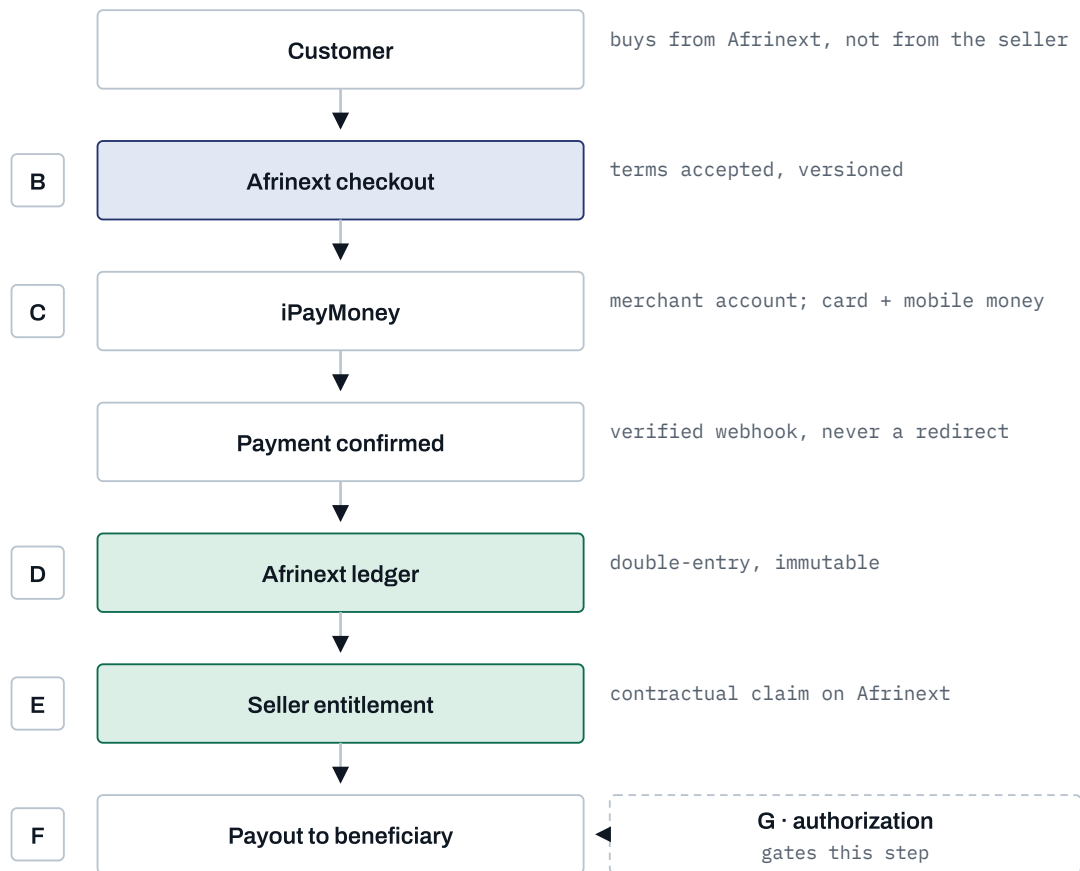
Afrinext is operated by **AFRI NEXT TECHNOLOGIE**, an *Entreprise Individuelle* registered in Niger, holding an NIF and an RCCM. Its registered activities include information technology, artificial intelligence, general commerce, service provision and import-export.

WHAT NIF AND RCCM ARE – AND ARE NOT

They establish that the business exists and is registered to trade: a tax identifier and a commercial-register entry. **They are not a payment-services or e-money licence.** Nothing in this document, in the product, in marketing copy, or in anything said to a user may describe them as one. Company registration and regulatory authorization are different things, granted by different authorities, for different activities.

The confirmed economic model

Afrinext operates as the **commercial platform of record**. The customer contracts with Afrinext, iPayMoney processes the payment, Afrinext's ledger records what each seller, instructor or partner is owed, and Afrinext pays the beneficiary under its own published terms and payout procedure. This is a confirmed business decision, and the architecture is built for it.



Each hop is governed by a different layer, and the layers are not interchangeable. The letters map to the table below. The one that is not yet settled — G — is the one that gates paying money out, which is why the payout rail is behind an interface rather than wired to a single provider.

Seven layers that must never be conflated

	LAYER	ESTABLISHED BY	DOES <i>NOT</i> ESTABLISH
A	Company registration AFRI NEXT TECHNOLOGIE exists and may trade	NIF, RCCM	Any right to conduct regulated payment activity
B	Contract with users Terms binding Afrinext and each user	Versioned acceptance records	Regulatory authorization
C	Payment-provider relationship Ability to accept card and mobile-money payments	iPayMoney merchant account	That Afrinext may itself hold or transmit funds as its own business activity
D	Afrinext internal ledger Authoritative record of who is owed what	Double-entry entries in Afrinext's database	Any claim on funds physically held anywhere
E	Seller economic entitlement A seller's claim against Afrinext	Ledger balance + accepted Seller Terms	A deposit, a bank balance, or protected client money
F	Payout operation The act of paying a beneficiary	Payout workflow + a provider or bank rail	Its own lawfulness — see G
G	Regulatory authorization Permission to conduct regulated payment activity	A licence, an exemption, or operating under a licensed institution	Nothing else in this table establishes it.

Afrinext intends to investigate and obtain whatever additional authorization its financial activities require. Until that is settled, three architectural consequences hold, and they are not negotiable in the code:

1. **The ledger models entitlement, not custody.** A seller's available balance is a contractual claim on Afrinext, and the schema, the API and the interface language all say so. No screen calls it a deposit, an account balance, or protected funds.
2. **The payout rail is an interface, not a provider.** Whatever posture G resolves to — Afrinext licensed, Afrinext operating under a licensed institution, or payouts executed by a third party — the change lands in one adapter, not across the codebase.
3. **Custody is an assumption, not a fact in the code.** Nothing in the ledger asserts where money physically sits. That is deliberate: if the answer changes, the accounting does not.

Consent: versioned, per document, per user

Users accept Afrinext's terms before using the commercial functionality those terms govern. Acceptance is recorded per document *version*, so the question

"which terms was this user bound by when they sold that course in March?"
has an answer.

```
CREATE TABLE legal_documents (  
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,  
  kind        text NOT NULL,      -- terms_of_use | privacy_policy | seller_terms |  
                                   -- instructor_terms | payment_refund_policy |  
                                   -- payout_terms | referral_terms | delivery_terms  
  country_code char(2),          -- NULL = applies everywhere  
  UNIQUE (kind, country_code)  
);  
  
CREATE TABLE legal_document_versions (  
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,  
  document_id uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES legal_documents(id),  
  version     text NOT NULL,      -- '2026-08-01' or semver; ordered by effective_from  
  locale      text NOT NULL,      -- fr | en  
  content_hash text NOT NULL,      -- sha256 of the exact text shown to the user  
  effective_from timestamptz NOT NULL,  
  UNIQUE (document_id, version, locale)  
);  
  
CREATE TABLE consent_records (  
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,  
  user_id     uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES users(id),  
  document_version_id uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES legal_document_versions(id),  
  accepted_at timestamptz NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),  
  ip_address  inet,  
  user_agent  text,  
  locale      text,  
  method      text NOT NULL,      -- signup_checkbox | seller_onboarding | reaccept ...  
  UNIQUE (user_id, document_version_id)  
);
```

Enforcement is a gate, not a banner: an action whose terms the user has not accepted at the *current effective version* is refused server-side, and the client is told which document to present. Publishing a new version therefore re-prompts affected users automatically, with the old acceptance preserved rather than overwritten — consent records are append-only, like ledger entries, for the same reason.

THE LINE THAT MUST NOT BE CROSSED

Consent establishes layer B. It does not establish layer G. A user agreeing to Afrinext's Payout Terms does not authorize Afrinext to conduct a regulated activity, and no amount of well-drafted terms substitutes for the competent authority's permission. Anyone who proposes otherwise has misread this section.



Technology stack

Every choice below is stated with the alternative I rejected, because several of them are genuine trade-offs rather than obvious calls.

LAYER	CHOICE	WHY THIS, OVER THE ALTERNATIVE
Language	TypeScript 5, strict	One language across web, worker and shared domain code. <code>strict</code> , <code>noUncheckedIndexedAccess</code> and <code>exactOptionalPropertyTypes</code> on from day one – retrofitting them into a 40-table codebase is miserable.
Web	Next.js 16, App Router	A marketplace lives or dies on organic search, so product, store and course pages need server rendering and stable URLs. React Server Components also ship less JavaScript to the low-end Android devices that dominate the target market. Rejected: a SPA + separate API, which doubles the deployment surface and loses SEO.
Domain logic	packages/core	Framework-free TypeScript. Next.js is transport, not the application. This is the single most important structural decision in the document – see section L.
Database	PostgreSQL 16+	Not negotiable. Real transactions, <code>SERIALIZABLE</code> isolation, <code>CHECK</code> and <code>EXCLUSION</code> constraints, deferred constraint triggers, partial indexes, <code>NUMERIC</code> , row-level locking, full-text search. The financial invariants belong in the database, not only in application code.
ORM	Drizzle ORM	See the decision block below – this one is contested.
Background jobs	pg-boss (Postgres-backed)	Lets a job be enqueued <i>inside the same transaction</i> as the ledger rows that job refers to. With Redis you get a two-phase failure: the database commits, the enqueue fails, and settlement silently never runs. Rejected: BullMQ + Redis, which is faster but buys throughput we do not have yet with a correctness hole we cannot afford. Revisit above roughly 100 jobs/second.
Auth	Better Auth + DB sessions	Phone-first OTP is a first-class requirement in this market, not an add-on. Database-backed sessions rather than stateless JWTs, because a session that controls a wallet must be revocable instantly. Rejected: Clerk and Auth0 (per-MAU USD pricing against XOF revenue), Lucia (retired upstream).
Validation	Zod	One schema per boundary – HTTP body, server action input, job payload, webhook payload – with types inferred rather than restated.
i18n	next-intl	French as the default locale, English second, locale in the URL path (<code>/fr/...</code>) so both index separately. Message catalogs live in <code>packages/i18n</code> so the worker can localise SMS and email too.
Styling	Tailwind v4 + tokens	Already in the repository, already token-driven, already dark-mode aware. No reason to change it.
Object storage	Cloudflare R2	Zero egress fees. For a platform whose core product is video in a market where bandwidth is the dominant cost, this is the difference between viable and not. S3-compatible, so the provider interface stays portable.
Video	Cloudflare Stream	Signed playback tokens, HLS adaptive bitrate, per-video access control. We store a <code>playback_id</code> , never a file URL. Alternatives worth pricing: Bunny Stream (cheaper), Mux (best tooling, most expensive). Rejected: MP4 files in a bucket – no adaptive bitrate on a 3G connection, and no way to expire access.
SMS / email	provider interface	SMS matters more than email here (OTP, order status, payout confirmations). Concrete provider chosen per country at deploy time; the interface is ours.
Observability	OpenTelemetry + Sentry	Structured logs carrying request id, actor id and ledger transaction id. A money platform without traceable financial events is not operable.

LAYER	CHOICE	WHY THIS, OVER THE ALTERNATIVE
Testing	Vitest + Playwright	Property-based unit tests on the ledger and commission engine; Playwright end-to-end on the purchase-to-payout path specifically.
Hosting	containers, Postgres in eu-west-3	Paris, not Cape Town: round-trip latency from Niamey, Bamako, Abidjan and Dakar to eu-west-3 is materially better than to af-south-1 . Cloudflare in front for edge caching. Vercel works for phases 0–2 but the worker is a long-running process that does not fit its model, so plan for containers.

CONTESTED DECISION

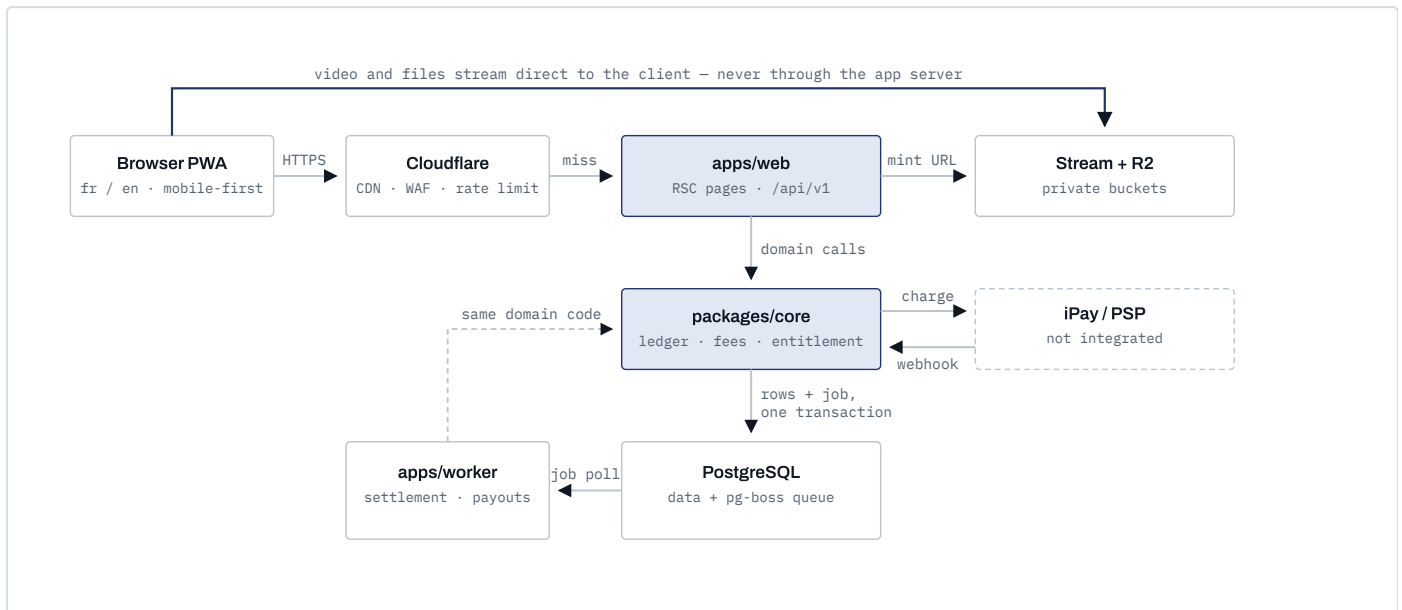
Drizzle ORM rather than Prisma

WHY	Migrations are plain SQL that a human reviews before it touches money. CHECK constraints, deferred constraint triggers and SELECT ... FOR UPDATE are expressible directly in the schema rather than through escape hatches. No query-engine binary, which matters for cold starts and for self-hosting cheaply.
INSTEAD OF	Prisma, which has better developer experience, better relational query ergonomics and far more mature migration tooling for a 40-table schema.
TRADE-OFF	More SQL written by hand, a smaller ecosystem, and a steeper ramp for developers who have only used Prisma.
SWITCH IF	The team is junior-weighted or Prisma-experienced. In that case take Prisma and write the ledger's critical paths as raw SQL — the schema in section C is unchanged either way. Tell me the team composition and I will pick.

System architecture

Four rules define the shape of the system. Everything else follows from them.

1. **Only `packages/core` touches the database.** Route handlers, server actions and job consumers all call the same domain services. There is no second path to the ledger.
2. **Jobs are enqueued in the transaction that creates their subject.** A settlement job and the ledger rows it will settle commit together or not at all.
3. **Media never passes through the application server.** The server mints a short-lived signed URL; the client fetches from storage directly.
4. **Webhooks are never processed inline.** Verify the signature, persist the raw event, return 200, and let the worker do the work. Payment providers retry aggressively and time out fast.



The database is the queue. Because pg-boss stores jobs in Postgres, a settlement job is inserted in the same transaction as the ledger entries it will later act on — the failure mode where money is recorded but its follow-up work is lost cannot occur. The dashed line from the worker means it imports `packages/core` rather than calling the web app.

Environments

Three: local (Docker Compose — Postgres, MinIO standing in for R2, a mock PSP), staging (real PSP sandbox, real Stream, anonymised data), production. Migrations run forward-only in CI with a tested rollback for each. Staging

must be able to run a full purchase-to-payout cycle before any production release touches the ledger.

Conventions that apply everywhere: UUIDv7 primary keys (time-sortable, so they index well and leak no sequence count); `timestampz` in UTC only; status enums rather than soft deletes except where retention law requires otherwise; and **money is never a bare number** — `amount_minor bigint` always travels with a `currency char(3)`.

AFRICA-SPECIFIC CORRECTNESS TRAP

XOF and XAF have **zero** decimal places. NGN (kobo) and GHS (pesewa) have two. Any code that assumes "minor units means cents, divide by 100" will be wrong by a factor of 100 across the entire UEMOA zone. The exponent comes from the `currencies` table, never from a constant.

The financial core

This is the part I would write first and change least. The rest of the schema can evolve; this cannot.

```

-- Money is always a pair, and the exponent is data, not a constant.
CREATE TABLE currencies (
  code      char(3) PRIMARY KEY,          -- XOF, XAF, NGN, GHS
  minor_unit smallint NOT NULL CHECK (minor_unit BETWEEN 0 AND 4),
  is_active  boolean NOT NULL DEFAULT true
);

CREATE TYPE ledger_account_kind AS ENUM (
  'user_available', -- withdrawable
  'user_pending',   -- earned, not yet releasable
  'platform_escrow', -- captured, owed to somebody, not yet split
  'platform_revenue',
  'psp_clearing',   -- money at the payment provider
  'payout_payable'  -- approved withdrawal, not yet paid out
);

CREATE TABLE ledger_accounts (
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,
  kind        ledger_account_kind NOT NULL,
  owner_type  text,                -- 'user' | 'store' | NULL for platform
  owner_id    uuid,
  currency    char(3) NOT NULL REFERENCES currencies(code),
  UNIQUE (kind, owner_type, owner_id, currency)
);

CREATE TABLE ledger_transactions (
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,          -- uuidv7
  kind        text NOT NULL,            -- capture | settlement | refund | payout ...
  occurred_at timestamptz NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  idempotency_key text UNIQUE,
  reverses_id uuid REFERENCES ledger_transactions(id),
  metadata    jsonb NOT NULL DEFAULT '{}' -- order_id, payment_id, actor...
);

CREATE TABLE ledger_entries (
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,
  transaction_id uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES ledger_transactions(id),
  account_id  uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES ledger_accounts(id),
  direction   smallint NOT NULL CHECK (direction IN (-1, 1)),
  amount_minor bigint NOT NULL CHECK (amount_minor > 0),
  currency    char(3) NOT NULL REFERENCES currencies(code)
);

-- Append-only. The application role cannot rewrite history.
REVOKE UPDATE, DELETE ON ledger_entries, ledger_transactions FROM afrinext_app;

-- Every transaction balances, per currency. Deferred, so all entries
-- can be inserted before the invariant is checked at COMMIT.
CREATE CONSTRAINT TRIGGER ledger_must_balance
  AFTER INSERT ON ledger_entries
  DEFERRABLE INITIALLY DEFERRED
  FOR EACH ROW EXECUTE FUNCTION assert_transaction_balanced();

-- A cache, never the truth. Rebuilt and asserted nightly.
CREATE TABLE account_balances (
  account_id  uuid PRIMARY KEY REFERENCES ledger_accounts(id),
  balance_minor bigint NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
  entry_count bigint NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
  updated_at  timestamptz NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
);

```

Entities by module

The brief listed candidate tables and asked me not to create them blindly. This is the filtered set, with the ones I would *not* build in phase 1 marked.

MODULE	TABLES	NOTES
Identity	users, user_identities, sessions, profiles, roles, permissions, role_permissions, role_assignments, countries, currencies, locales	<code>user_identities</code> holds one row per credential (phone, email, future OAuth) so a user can add a second login method without a schema change. <code>role_assignments</code> is scoped — see section D.
Stores	stores, store_settings, store_payout_accounts, <code>STORE_MEMBERS</code>	The <i>store</i> is the seller, not the user — orders reference <code>store_id</code> . <code>store_members</code> is deferred until multi-person stores are actually requested.
Catalog	categories, products, product_media, digital_assets, <code>PRODUCT_VARIANTS</code> , <code>INVENTORY_ITEMS</code> , <code>SERVICE_OFFERINGS</code>	One <code>products</code> table with a <code>kind</code> discriminator plus kind-specific side tables. Variants and inventory arrive with physical goods; service offerings with the services module.
Learn	courses, course_modules, course_lessons, lesson_assets, course_enrollments, lesson_progress, <code>COURSE_CERTIFICATES</code>	Certificates are a future feature in the brief and stay that way — but <code>enrollments</code> carries the completion data a certificate would need.
Commerce	carts, cart_items, checkout_groups, orders, order_items, order_fee_lines, order_events	<code>order_fee_lines</code> is the frozen commission snapshot — the reason changing a commission rate never rewrites history.
Payments	payment_intents, payment_attempts, payment_events, refunds	<code>payment_events</code> stores the raw provider payload with a <code>UNIQUE (provider, provider_event_id)</code> — this single constraint is what makes webhook replay harmless.
Ledger	ledger_accounts, ledger_transactions, ledger_entries, account_balances, settlement_holds, commission_rules, idempotency_keys	Above.
Payouts	withdrawal_requests, payout_batches, kyc_records	KYC tiers gate withdrawal ceilings. See section K.
Delivery	delivery_partners, delivery_orders, delivery_events, delivery_proofs, <code>CASH_COLLECTIONS</code>	Deferred to the physical-goods phase. <code>cash_collections</code> models the rider's cash float — see section I.
Referral	referral_programs, referral_codes, referral_attributions, referral_commissions	No <code>referral_relationships</code> tree — single level only, see section H.
Trust & ops	reviews, notifications, audit_logs, platform_settings, feature_flags, <code>DISPUTES</code> , <code>DISPUTE_MESSAGES</code>	Disputes arrive with physical goods, where they actually occur. Digital refunds in phase 1 are an admin action against an audited reversal.

Tables from the brief I would **not** create: `referral_relationships` (implied by single-level attribution), `user_roles` (superseded by scoped

`role_assignments`), and a separate `services` table (services are `products` with `kind = 'service'`).

Authentication

- **Phone + OTP is the primary method**, email + password secondary. Phone penetration far exceeds email use in the target countries, and phone is already the identifier for mobile money.
- **Database sessions, not JWTs.** An opaque token in an `httpOnly; Secure; SameSite=Lax` cookie, resolved against `sessions` on each request. A JWT cannot be revoked before it expires; a session that can move money must be killable in one query.
- Session rotation on privilege change, sign-in and password change. Shorter idle timeout for admin sessions than for shoppers.
- **Step-up re-verification** for money-sensitive actions: requesting a withdrawal, adding or changing a payout account, changing the phone number.

Authorization

Roles are scoped, additive rows. A single user simultaneously being a buyer, an instructor, a rider in Niamey and staff on someone else's store is the normal case, not an edge case.

```
CREATE TABLE role_assignments (
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,
  user_id     uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES users(id),
  role_id     uuid NOT NULL REFERENCES roles(id),
  scope_type  text NOT NULL,    -- 'global' | 'store' | 'course' | 'zone'
  scope_id    uuid,            -- NULL when scope_type = 'global'
  granted_by  uuid REFERENCES users(id),
  granted_at  timestampz NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
  UNIQUE (user_id, role_id, scope_type, scope_id)
);
```

Permissions are strings of the form `resource.action` — `product.publish`, `order.refund`, `withdrawal.approve`, `lesson.view`. Roles hold sets of them. Every check goes through one function:

```
// packages/core/authz — the only permission gate in the system.
await authorize(actor, 'product.publish', { type: 'store', id: storeId });
```

RULE

IDOR is prevented by **scoping the query**, not by fetching a row and then checking it. Repository methods take the actor and constrain in SQL: a seller's order list is `WHERE store_id = ANY(actor.storeIds)` , never `findById()` followed by an ownership test. The second pattern works until someone forgets it once.

ADMINISTRATIVE ROLES ARE SPLIT BY LEAST PRIVILEGE

ROLE	CAN	CANNOT
support	Read users, orders, enrollments; resend receipts; open disputes	Touch the ledger, approve payouts, change commission rules
ops	Moderate catalog, verify stores, manage categories and delivery zones	Anything financial
finance	Approve withdrawals, issue refunds, post adjustments, view the ledger	Edit catalog, change permissions, alter user identities
superadmin	Role and settings administration	Approve their own withdrawal — a hard, code-level self-approval block

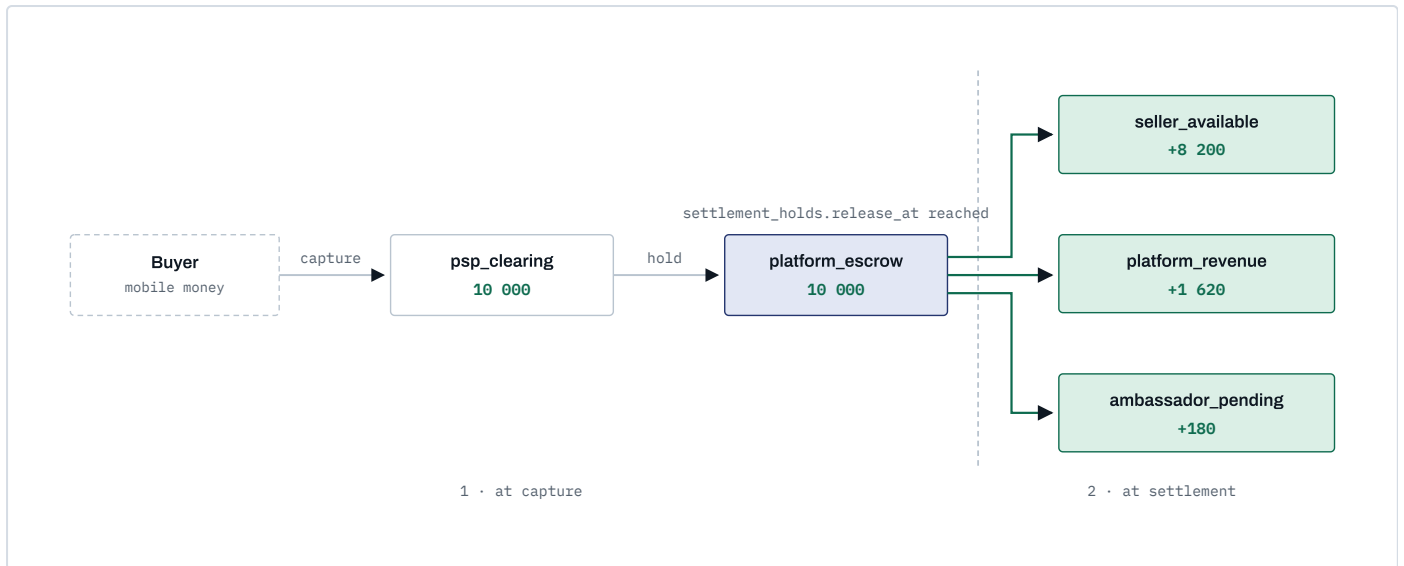
The wallet is not a balance field with rules around it. It is a **double-entry ledger**, and the balance is a derived quantity that we cache for speed and verify continuously.

The four invariants

1. **Entries are immutable.** No UPDATE, no DELETE — enforced by revoked grants, not by convention. A mistake is corrected by posting a compensating transaction linked through `reverses_id`.
2. **Every transaction balances.** Per transaction, per currency, the signed sum of entries is zero. A deferred constraint trigger rejects the COMMIT otherwise. Money cannot be created or destroyed by application code.
3. **Balances are cached, not authoritative.** `account_balances` is updated inside the same transaction under a row lock; a nightly job recomputes `SUM(direction × amount_minor)` per account and alarms on any drift.
4. **No floating point, anywhere.** `bigint` minor units and a currency code, from the database through the API to the rendered price.

Pending versus available

These are not statuses on a row. They are **two different accounts**, and "funds becoming withdrawable" is a transfer between them. That means the question "why is my money still pending?" is answerable by pointing at a specific ledger transaction and its `settlement_holds` row, rather than by reading application logic.



One 10 000 XOF course sale, at an 18% platform commission with a 10% referral program. Every arrow is one balanced ledger transaction. Note where the referral is drawn from: 180 is 10% of the *platform's* 1 800, not of the gross — so referral cost can never exceed what the platform earned on that sale. The ambassador's share lands in `pending` and is released separately once the buyer's refund window closes. For physical goods the seller's share also lands in `seller_pending` and moves to `available` on a second transaction when the delivery hold expires.

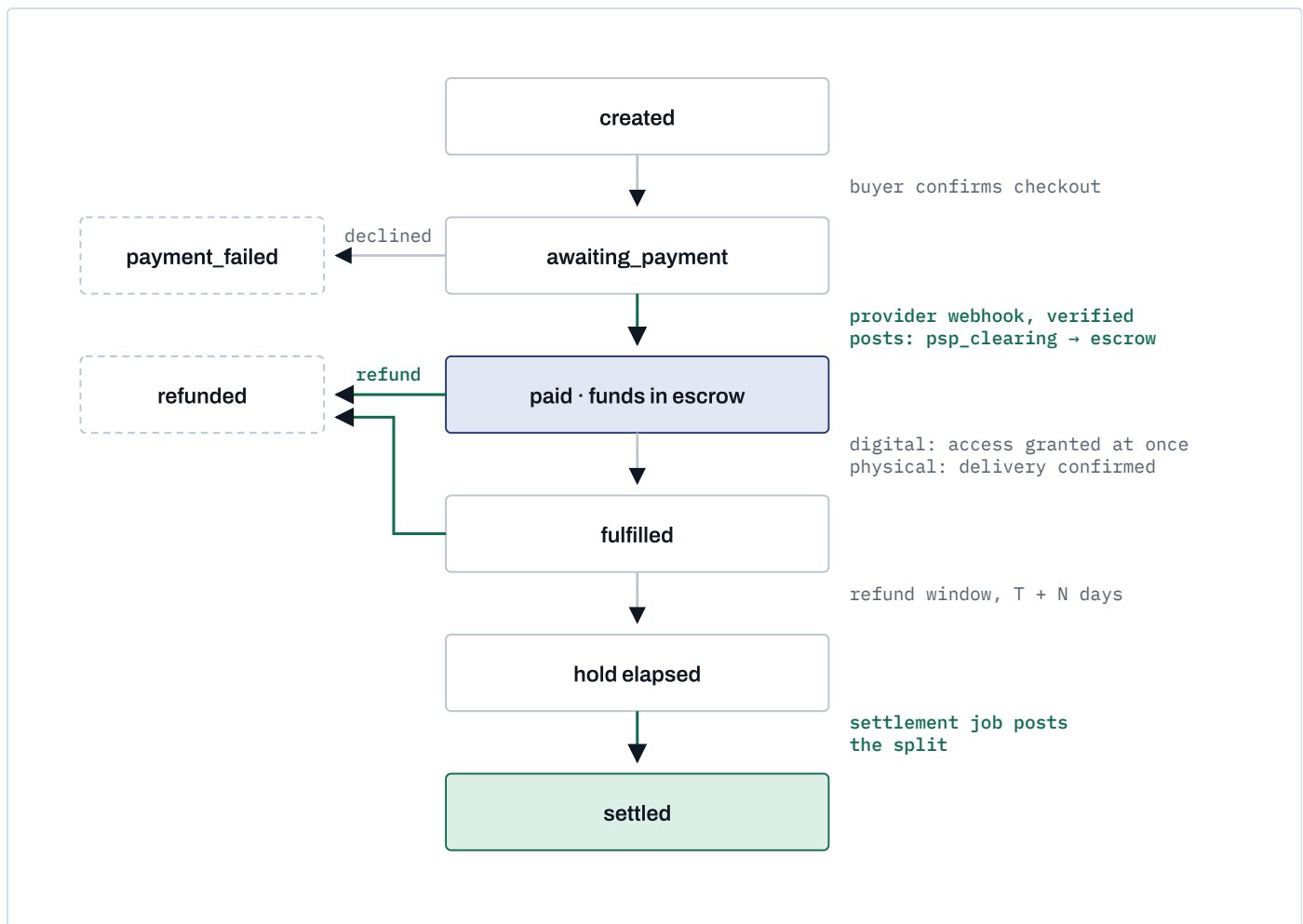
Rounding: the residual rule

Commission percentages rarely divide cleanly into whole francs. The rule is fixed and applied everywhere:

1. Compute every non-seller line (platform, referral, delivery) in minor units, rounding **half up**.
2. The seller's line is `gross - Σ(all other lines)`, never computed independently.

The split therefore re-sums to the gross by construction. No minor unit is ever created or lost to rounding, and the residual consistently favours the seller — a defensible position if it is ever questioned.

When money moves



Green transitions post ledger entries; grey ones only change order state.

Money enters escrow when the provider webhook is verified — never when the buyer returns from a redirect. A dispute does not get its own state: it *extends* the hold by pushing `settlement_holds.release_at` forward, so disputed money simply never reaches `available` while the dispute is open.

The commission engine

Rules are data. Resolution happens once, at order creation, and the result is frozen.

```
CREATE TABLE commission_rules (
  id          uuid PRIMARY KEY,
  transaction_type text NOT NULL, -- digital | course | physical | service | delivery | referral
  country_code char(2),          -- NULL = any
  category_id  uuid,             -- NULL = any
  store_id     uuid,             -- NULL = any; a negotiated rate for one seller
  rate_bps     integer,          -- basis points; 1800 = 18.00%
  fixed_minor  bigint,
  currency     char(3) REFERENCES currencies(code),
  priority     integer NOT NULL,
  effective_from timestampz NOT NULL,
  effective_to  timestampz
);
```

Resolution is most-specific-wins, broken by `priority` and then by `effective_from` — deterministic, and unit-testable in isolation. The resolved outcome is written to `order_fee_lines` with the `rule_id`, the basis and the computed amount.

WHY THE SNAPSHOT MATTERS

Raise the platform commission from 18% to 20% next quarter and **no historical order changes**. Every past settlement can still be re-derived from its own fee lines, and any seller asking "why did I receive this amount?" gets an answer that references the rule that was live at the moment they sold. A system that recomputes fees from current rules cannot answer that question truthfully.

Withdrawals

1. Request → validated against KYC tier ceiling, minimum amount, available balance, payout-account cooling period, and absence of open disputes.
2. Approved (automatically under a configured threshold, by `finance` above it) → ledger posts `user_available` → `payout_payable`. The money leaves the withdrawable balance at approval, so it cannot be double-spent while the payout is in flight.
3. Payout executed through the provider → on confirmation, `payout_payable` → `psp_clearing`.
4. On failure, a compensating transaction returns the amount to `user_available` and the request is marked failed with the provider's reason.

One products table, three kinds

`products.kind ∈ {physical, digital, service}`, with kind-specific side tables (`product_variants` + `inventory_items`, `digital_assets`, `service_offerings`). Not three separate tables — because carts, order items, reviews, search, favourites and fee resolution all need a single polymorphic target, and a three-table design forces a nullable triple foreign key into `order_items` that every query then has to unpack.

What differs between kinds is **fulfilment and hold policy**, and that lives in one place:

KIND	FULFILLED WHEN	DEFAULT HOLD
digital	Payment verified	24 h
course	Enrollment created	72 h
service	Buyer confirms, or auto after N days	7 d
physical	Delivery confirmed with proof	7 d

These are defaults in `platform_settings`, overridable per country and per category from the admin console — not constants in code.

Stores are the seller

Orders reference `store_id`, never `user_id`. This costs nothing now and buys three things later: a user can run more than one store; a store can gain staff without reshaping the order history; and a store can be transferred or suspended without touching the person's account, wallet or other roles.

Multi-store carts

A buyer will put a course from Dakar and a bag of shea butter from Bamako in one cart. At checkout the cart splits into **one order per store**, grouped under a `checkout_group_id`, paid by a single payment intent. Each order then settles independently on its own timeline — the course in 72 hours, the shea butter when it is delivered. Attempting to keep them as one order forces every fulfilment and refund decision to be all-or-nothing.

Search

Postgres full-text search with a generated `tsvector` column, plus `pg_trgm` for typo tolerance, and a French text-search configuration alongside English. Facets come from ordinary indexed columns. Move to Meilisearch or Typesense when the catalog passes roughly 100 000 rows or when faceted search gets heavy — not before, and not to Elasticsearch, which is an operational burden this team should not carry at launch.

Reviews

Only from a verified purchase: `reviews.order_item_id` is a required foreign key, unique per buyer per item. This kills fake-review farming structurally rather than through moderation, which matters when reviews feed seller ranking and seller ranking feeds income.

Structure is conventional — `courses` → `course_modules` → `course_lessons` → `lesson_assets`, with lesson kinds `video` | `pdf` | `text`. The interesting parts are entitlement and bandwidth.

Entitlement is checked at token-mint time, on every request

1. The player asks `GET /api/v1/learn/lessons/:id/playback`.
2. The server resolves the actor, checks `course_enrollments` for a live entitlement (and `access_expires_at` if the course is time-limited), and calls `authorize(actor, 'lesson.view', {course})`.
3. Only then does it mint a **signed Stream token, scoped to that user, valid 2–5 minutes**, and return an HLS manifest URL.
4. The player refreshes the token mid-playback as it nears expiry.
5. Every mint is written to `audit_logs` — which also gives instructors real "who watched what" analytics for free.

NEVER

Paid course content never has a permanent public URL. Not in a public bucket, not behind an unguessable path, not with a long-lived signed URL. An unguessable URL is a password that gets forwarded on WhatsApp.

Downloads are a per-asset instructor choice

`lesson_assets.downloadable boolean`, set by the instructor per asset. When true, downloading issues a separate short-TTL signed URL, logged, and rate-limited per user. When false, no download URL is ever minted — the flag is enforced server-side at mint time, not by hiding a button.

What is realistic about protection

BE HONEST WITH INSTRUCTORS

Signed short-lived URLs plus a burned-in overlay carrying the viewer's phone number make casual re-sharing traceable and inconvenient. They do **not** prevent a determined screen recording. Genuine prevention requires Widevine/FairPlay DRM, which is expensive and out of scope here. Instructors should be told this plainly rather than sold an assurance the platform cannot honour.

Progress and resume

`lesson_progress(enrollment_id, lesson_id, position_seconds, furthest_seconds, completed_at)` , written by a heartbeat every ~15 seconds, throttled, and flushed on pause and on unload via `sendBeacon` .

`course_enrollments.last_lesson_id` gives cross-device resume: the learner picks up on their phone exactly where they stopped on a shared laptop.

Keeping `furthest_seconds` separate from `position_seconds` means scrubbing backwards does not destroy completion state.

Built for the actual network

- An encoding ladder that **starts at 240p**, not at 720p. Adaptive bitrate matters far more here than peak quality.
- An audio-only rendition for lecture-style courses, selectable by the learner to save data.
- Progress writes are a few dozen bytes and batched — a learner should never lose their place because the heartbeat could not get through.
- Where the instructor permits downloads, offline viewing is the difference between a finished course and an abandoned one.

The brief's principle — pay for real economic activity, never for recruitment — is enforced structurally here, not by policy text.

Attribution

- An ambassador gets a code; the link is `/r/:code`, which sets a first-party cookie (90 days) and redirects.
- At signup the cookie is consumed into `referral_attributions(referrer_user_id, referred_user_id, program_id, attributed_at, expires_at)`, with `UNIQUE(referred_user_id)`.
- **First touch, immutable.** The first ambassador to introduce someone keeps the attribution. Last-touch invites a scramble to overwrite each other's referrals just before a purchase.

Qualification

A commission is created only when a **settled ledger transaction** of a configured type exists — not at signup, not on profile completion, not on "becoming active". There is no code path that pays for a registration, because commissions are computed by a job that reads settled transactions and has no other input.

CONFIGURABLE PER PROGRAM	EXAMPLE
Basis	platform_revenue
Rate	1000 bps (10%)
Duration from attribution	365 days
Per-referral lifetime cap	150 000 XOF
Eligible transaction types	course, digital, physical, service
Country scope	NE, ML, BF ...

CONFIRMED DECISION

Single level only — no downline of a downline

WHY	Confirmed by the business: A earns from B's qualifying activity; A never earns from B → C. Multi-level structures are where recruitment-scheme regulatory attention concentrates, and they contradict Afrinext's own stated principle. One level keeps the model explainable to a regulator in one sentence: "we share part of our commission with whoever introduced the seller."
INSTEAD OF	Two or more tiers, which measurably increases ambassador enthusiasm and measurably increases legal exposure.
TRADE-OFF	Slower ambassador-network growth than a tiered scheme would produce.
NOTE	Because the commission basis is platform revenue, the payout is bounded by definition — the platform can never owe more in referral than it earned on the sale. That guardrail is what makes the program safe to run at all, and it disappears if the basis is ever changed to gross.

Fraud controls

- Self-referral detection across phone number, device fingerprint, payout account and payment instrument.
- Referral commissions land in `ambassador_pending` and release only after the underlying order clears its refund window — so a wash sale that is refunded never pays out.
- Velocity limits per ambassador, with automatic hold and review above configured thresholds.
- Circular attribution (A refers B refers A) rejected at write time.

Deferred to the physical-goods phase, but designed now because it constrains the order state machine.

STATE MACHINE

requested → offered → accepted → picked_up → in_transit → delivered , with failed and cancelled as terminal branches. Every transition writes a delivery_events row with actor, timestamp and GPS point — the audit trail is the record, the current status is a cached projection of it.

DISPATCH

Offers broadcast to eligible partners in the zone; first acceptance wins via a conditional update (UPDATE ... WHERE status = 'offered') so two riders can never both hold the same job. Unaccepted offers expire and re-broadcast with a widening radius.

PROOF OF DELIVERY

A short OTP shown in the buyer's app and entered by the rider, plus an optional photo and the GPS fix at completion. The OTP is what flips the order to fulfilled and starts the settlement hold — a rider cannot self-declare a delivery into existence.

RIDERS LOSE SIGNAL CONSTANTLY

The rider interface queues state transitions locally and replays them with idempotency keys when connectivity returns. A transition applied twice must be a no-op; a transition applied out of order must be rejected by the state machine, not silently accepted.

CASH ON DELIVERY IS A BIGGER PROBLEM THAN IT LOOKS

COD is the dominant payment method for physical goods across much of the region, and it inverts the money flow: the rider collects cash, so the platform is owed money by the rider rather than holding the buyer's funds. That needs a cash_collections liability account per rider, a deposit and reconciliation process, float limits, and a real operational routine — it is a project, not a checkbox. **My recommendation is to launch physical goods prepaid-only and add COD as its own phase with its own design.**

Two entry styles, one implementation. **Server Actions** for first-party form mutations (fewer round trips, progressive enhancement) and **versioned REST** at `/api/v1/*` for everything a future native app, an ambassador tool or a partner integration would consume. Both call the same `packages/core` services. Logic is never duplicated between them, and neither one is allowed a private path to the database.

DOMAIN	REPRESENTATIVE ENDPOINTS
auth	POST <code>/auth/otp/request</code> · <code>/auth/otp/verify</code> · <code>/auth/session</code> · DELETE <code>/auth/session</code>
me	GET <code>/me</code> · PATCH <code>/me</code> · GET <code>/me/roles</code> · GET <code>/me/orders</code> · GET <code>/me/enrollments</code>
stores	POST <code>/stores</code> · GET <code>/stores/:slug</code> · PATCH <code>/stores/:id</code> · GET <code>/stores/:id/analytics</code>
catalog	GET <code>/products</code> · GET <code>/products/:slug</code> · POST <code>/stores/:id/products</code> · POST <code>/products/:id/publish</code>
search	GET <code>/search?q&kind&category&country&cursor</code>
cart · checkout	GET/POST <code>/cart/items</code> · POST <code>/checkout</code> · GET <code>/checkout/:groupId</code>
orders	GET <code>/orders</code> · GET <code>/orders/:id</code> · POST <code>/orders/:id/cancel</code> · POST <code>/orders/:id/refund</code>
payments	POST <code>/payments/intents</code> · GET <code>/payments/:id</code> · POST <code>/webhooks/:provider</code>
wallet	GET <code>/wallet</code> · GET <code>/wallet/transactions</code> · POST <code>/wallet/withdrawals</code> · GET <code>/wallet/withdrawals/:id</code>
learn	GET <code>/courses/:slug</code> · GET <code>/learn/lessons/:id</code> · POST <code>/learn/lessons/:id/progress</code> · GET <code>/learn/lessons/:id/playback</code>
delivery	GET <code>/delivery/offers</code> · POST <code>/delivery/:id/accept</code> · POST <code>/delivery/:id/transition</code>
referrals	GET <code>/referrals/me</code> · GET <code>/referrals/commissions</code> · GET <code>/r/:code</code>
admin	<code>/admin/*</code> – mirrors the above under <code>admin.*</code> permissions

CONVENTIONS

- **Idempotency-Key** is required on every POST that moves money. The key, the request hash and the resulting transaction id are stored; a replay returns the original response rather than acting twice.
- Cursor pagination everywhere (`?cursor=&limit=`). Offset pagination on a growing catalog silently skips and duplicates rows.
- Responses are `{ data, meta }`; errors are `{ error: { code, message, fields } }` with **stable machine-readable codes** — clients must never branch on message text, which is localised.
- Money crosses the wire as `{ amountMinor: 8200, currency: "XOF" }`. Never a formatted string, never a float.
- Rate limits by route class: strictest on OTP send and verify, then auth, then write, then read.
- Webhooks return `200` as fast as possible after signature verification and persistence. All work happens in the worker.

CONTROL	WHERE IT IS ENFORCED
Authentication	Opaque session tokens in <code>httpOnly; Secure; SameSite=Lax</code> cookies, resolved server-side. Rotated on sign-in and privilege change. Argon2id for the password path.
Step-up verification	Fresh OTP required for withdrawal requests, payout-account changes and phone changes — regardless of session age.
Authorization	One <code>authorize()</code> choke point in <code>packages/core/authz</code> . No route handler makes its own decision.
IDOR	Prevented by scoping queries to the actor in SQL, not by post-fetch ownership checks.
Input validation	Zod at every boundary; database CHECK and FK constraints as the last line. Frontend validation is a convenience and is never trusted.
Rate limiting	Per IP and per user, at the edge and in the app. Hardest limits on OTP send/verify, login, withdrawal, and playback-token minting.
Webhook integrity	Signature verified against the raw body before parsing; timestamp freshness window; <code>UNIQUE (provider, provider_event_id)</code> makes replay a no-op.
File access	Private buckets only. Short-TTL signed URLs minted after an entitlement check. Every mint audited.
Payment card data	Never touched. Provider-hosted collection only, which keeps PCI scope at SAQ-A. This is a deliberate architectural constraint, not an oversight.
Audit	Append-only <code>audit_logs</code> for every admin action and every financial state change: actor, action, target, before/after, IP, user agent, request id.
Fraud	Velocity checks, device fingerprinting, a cooling period before first withdrawal to a newly added payout account, and automatic hold-and-review thresholds.
Separation of duty	No user can approve a withdrawal to an account they control. Enforced in code, not in policy.
Secrets	Environment only, distinct per environment, rotated. Sandbox and production provider credentials never coexist in one config.
Data protection	PII minimised and encrypted at rest; retention policy per data class; export and deletion paths built for Nigeria's NDPR, Ghana's Data Protection Act and UEMOA national regimes.

EXPLICITLY OUT OF SCOPE, AND NAMED AS SUCH

DRM for video (Widevine/FairPlay). A third-party penetration test — which should be scheduled and budgeted *before* public launch, not after. Formal PCI-DSS certification beyond SAQ-A. Automated AML transaction-monitoring beyond threshold rules.

pnpm workspaces plus Turborepo. The directory layout is not cosmetic — it is what physically prevents domain logic from leaking into the framework.

```

afrinext/
├─ apps/
│  ├─ web/           Next.js 16 – pages, route handlers, server actions
│  └─ worker/        long-running pg-boss consumers
├─ packages/
│  ├─ core/          framework-free domain logic – the application
│  │  ├─ money/       Money type, minor units, rounding, formatting
│  │  ├─ ledger/      posting, balances, reconciliation
│  │  ├─ commissions/ rule resolution, fee snapshots
│  │  ├─ orders/      order + settlement state machines
│  │  ├─ payments/    PaymentProvider interface + registry
│  │  ├─ learn/       entitlement, playback tokens, progress
│  │  ├─ delivery/
│  │  └─ referrals/
│  │     └─ authz/    permissions, authorize()
│  ├─ db/            Drizzle schema, SQL migrations, seeds
│  ├─ providers/     psp-ipay, psp-manual, storage-r2, video-stream, sms, email
│  ├─ ui/            design system (seeded from today's prototype)
│  ├─ i18n/          fr / en message catalogs, shared with the worker
│  └─ config/        tsconfig, eslint, tailwind preset
├─ docs/
│  └─ architecture/  this document
│  └─ adr/            architecture decision records, numbered
│  └─ runbooks/       reconciliation drift, stuck payout, failed webhook
└─ infra/            docker, compose, CI, deploy

```

THE RULE THAT MAKES THIS WORTH DOING

`packages/core` may import `packages/db`. It may **not** import anything from `next`, and this is enforced by an ESLint boundary rule in CI, not by discipline. The consequence: the ledger and commission engine are testable in milliseconds without a server, the worker runs identical business logic to the web app, and extracting a standalone API service later is a packaging change rather than a rewrite.

Development roadmap

Phases are ordered by *irreversibility*, not by visibility. The money spine comes before any product feature, because it is the thing that cannot be retrofitted. Durations assume two to three engineers and are estimates, not commitments.

PHASE	SCOPE	EXIT CRITERION – THE THING THAT MUST DEMONSTRABLY WORK	EST.
P0 Foundations	Monorepo, Postgres, Drizzle schema v1, auth (phone OTP + email), scoped RBAC, i18n, design system extraction, CI, observability skeleton	A user registers by phone, signs in, switches language. CI runs typecheck, lint, tests and migrations forward and back on every commit.	2 wk
P1 Money spine	money , ledger , commission engine, idempotency, settlement holds, reconciliation job, admin ledger viewer	Property-based tests over 10 000 randomised operations prove every transaction balances and the cached balance equals the sum of entries. An injected drift is caught by the reconciliation job. No product feature is built before this passes.	3 wk
P2 Stores & catalog	Store creation, digital products and courses as products, categories, media upload to R2, public storefront and product pages, search	A seller publishes a paid digital product that renders server-side at a public URL with correct metadata and appears in search.	3 wk
P3 Cycle closed, no PSP	Cart, checkout, orders, fee snapshots, and a ManualTransferProvider where an admin confirms receipt	The complete economic cycle runs end to end without any payment integration: buyer orders → admin confirms → ledger settles → seller sees earnings → requests withdrawal → finance marks it paid. This de-risks everything that depends on iPay.	3 wk
P4 iPay	Real provider implementation behind the existing interface	In sandbox: charge created, webhook signature verified, status query reconciled, refund executed, replay proven harmless. GATED Cannot start until the documentation and sandbox credentials in section P are in hand.	unknown
P5 Afrinext Learn	Modules, lessons, Stream upload, entitlement, signed playback, progress and resume, download flag, learner interface	An automated test proves a paid lesson is unplayable without entitlement, and that resume works across two devices for one learner.	4 wk
P6 Wallet & payouts	Wallet interface, KYC tiers, withdrawal flow with step-up auth, payout batches, finance console	Full withdrawal lifecycle including a provider failure that correctly reverses back to available balance.	3 wk
P7 Network	Referral programs, attribution, qualification, commissions, ambassador dashboard, fraud checks	Tests prove a commission can only originate from a settled transaction, that self-referral is blocked, and that a refunded order pays nothing.	3 wk
P8 Physical & delivery	Variants, inventory, shipping, delivery partner interface, state machine, proof of delivery, delivery earnings	A physical order settles only on OTP-confirmed delivery, and a rider replaying a queued transition twice changes nothing.	5 wk
P9 Services & creators	Service offerings, booking and request flow, creator categories and portfolios	A service settles on buyer confirmation, and on auto-confirmation after the configured window.	3 wk
P10 Hardening	Load test, penetration test, runbooks, restore drill, compliance review, admin settings completeness	A database restore is performed from backup against a stopwatch, and the recovery time is written down.	3 wk

The admin console is **not** a phase. Each phase ships the admin surface for what it built; an admin console deferred to the end is an admin console that never gets finished.

To the recommended launch vertical (P0–P3, P5, P6, plus P4 whenever iPay unblocks): roughly 18 weeks. Full scope as briefed: roughly 32 weeks. If iPay stalls, P3's manual rail means you can onboard real sellers and take real money by bank transfer while it is resolved.

RISK 1 – THE ONE THAT CAN STOP THE PROJECT

Afrinext receiving customer money and paying sellers may be a regulated activity. The operator, AFRI NEXT TECHNOLOGIE, is a registered *Entreprise Individuelle* with an NIF and RCCM — which establishes layer A in section 01, and nothing beyond it. In the UEMOA zone, taking money from a buyer, holding a seller's entitlement and disbursing it can fall under BCEAO e-money and payment-services rules. Afrinext intends to investigate and obtain whatever authorization is required. Until that resolves, the architecture reduces exposure the only way engineering can: the ledger records *entitlement* rather than asserting custody, and the payout rail sits behind an interface so the answer can change without a rewrite. **This gates P6 (payouts), not P0 or P1.**

RISK	SEV	MITIGATION
Ledger correctness — a bug here is money, and it is discovered by users	HIGH	Double-entry with database-enforced balancing, immutability by revoked grants, property-based tests, nightly reconciliation with alarms, ledger built in P1 before anything depends on it
iPay is an unknown — the API may lack payouts or refunds entirely	HIGH	Provider abstraction plus the manual rail in P3, so no other phase is blocked. Section P lists exactly what is needed to remove this risk
Referral fraud and scheme perception	MED	Single level, commission drawn from platform revenue only, qualification from settled transactions only, pending-until-refund-window, self-referral detection
Scope — the brief is a 32-week product and enthusiasm compounds	HIGH	The launch vertical in section 00; phases with hard exit criteria; nothing starts until the prior phase's criterion demonstrably passes
KYC and AML on withdrawals	MED	Tiered KYC with withdrawal ceilings per tier; identity verification before the first payout; threshold-based holds. Provider choice still open
Mobile money reversal semantics differ from cards and vary by operator	MED	Conservative hold windows, configurable per country and per provider; never assume card-like chargeback behaviour
Video bandwidth cost and learner data cost	MED	R2 zero-egress, ladder starting at 240p, audio-only rendition, permitted offline download
Latency from West Africa	LOW	Postgres in <code>eu-west-3</code> , Cloudflare edge caching. Measure real round-trip from Niamey, Lagos and Accra in P0 and revisit if the numbers disagree with the assumption
Cash on delivery reconciliation	MED	Recommend launching physical goods prepaid-only; COD gets its own phase and its own liability model
Cross-jurisdiction data protection	MED	PII minimisation, encryption at rest, per-class retention, export and deletion paths built in P0 rather than bolted on
Operating a money system on-call	MED	Runbooks written in the phase that creates the failure mode; reconciliation alarms route to a human; restore drill rehearsed in P10

P

iPayMoney: confirmed provider, unverified API

iPayMoney is the confirmed initial payment provider, and Afrinext already holds a merchant account. That settles the commercial question. It does not settle the engineering one.

VERIFICATION STATUS – READ BEFORE TRUSTING ANYTHING BELOW

The official iPayMoney documentation is **not present in this repository**, and the provider's domain is **not reachable from the build environment** – outbound egress to it is blocked by the network policy. I have therefore verified *nothing* about their API: not the authentication scheme, not an endpoint, not a payload, not a webhook signature, not a status value.

The capabilities reported to me – Mobile Money, credit cards, local and international cards, a JavaScript SDK and an Android SDK – are recorded here as **stated by the business, pending confirmation from the official documentation**. No code treats them as facts.

ITEM	STATE
<code>PaymentProvider</code> interface	BUILT Provider-agnostic; nothing in it assumes iPayMoney.
<code>MockPaymentProvider</code>	BUILT Deterministic, in-process, for development and tests. Refuses to load when <code>NODE_ENV=production</code> .
<code>iPayMoneyProvider</code> adapter	BOUNDARY ONLY The adapter and its registration exist; every method throws <code>ProviderNotConfiguredError</code> naming the missing documentation. It cannot silently appear to work.
Real endpoints, auth, payloads, webhook verification	NOT IMPLEMENTED Blocked on the list below.
Integration test structure	PREPARED Specs exist and skip unless sandbox credentials are present in the environment.

The abstraction Afrinext codes against. `createPayout` is optional deliberately – if iPayMoney has no disbursement API, payouts run as an operational batch and the platform still works, but the finance team's workload changes substantially, so it is worth establishing early.

```
interface PaymentProvider {
  readonly id: string;
  createCharge(input: ChargeInput): Promise<ChargeResult>;
  getCharge(providerRef: string): Promise<ChargeStatus>;
  verifyWebhook(rawBody: Buffer, headers: HeadersLike): Promise<VerifiedEvent>;
  refund(input: RefundInput): Promise<RefundResult>;
  createPayout?(input: PayoutInput): Promise<PayoutResult>; // may not exist
  getPayout?(providerRef: string): Promise<PayoutStatus>;
}
```

Exactly what is needed to unblock the adapter

Items 6, 7 and 8 are the ones that most often invalidate an assumed design, so they matter most.

#	REQUIRED FROM THE OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION	WHY IT BLOCKS
1	Base URLs, sandbox and production	Nothing can be called without them
2	Authentication scheme (API key, HMAC, OAuth) and where credentials go in a request	Determines secret storage and rotation
3	Charge initiation request/response schema, and supported channels per country	Determines the checkout data model
4	Flow type: hosted redirect, inline widget, JS SDK, or USSD push	Changes the checkout interface, not just the backend
5	Status query endpoint and the <i>complete</i> status enumeration	Reconciliation cannot be written against a partial enum
6	Webhooks: registration, payload schema, signature algorithm and header name, timestamp tolerance, retry policy	Money enters the ledger on a verified webhook; with no signature scheme there is no safe way to accept one
7	Currency handling — specifically whether XOF is sent as whole francs	XOF has zero decimal places; a wrong assumption is a 100× error
8	Whether a payout/disbursement API exists, and its settlement timing	Decides whether payouts are automated or operational
9	Refund API and its constraints (partial refunds, time limits)	The refund reversal path in the ledger
10	Idempotency support on charge creation, and rate limits	Retry safety
11	Settlement schedule to the merchant account (T+N) and fee structure	Hold windows and platform margin
12	Sandbox credentials and test numbers or accounts per channel	Nothing can be tested without them
13	JavaScript and Android SDK documentation, if the SDK route is used	Changes the client integration entirely

Drop the documentation into `docs/providers/ipaymoney/` in any form — PDF, exported HTML, an OpenAPI file, a Postman collection. Once it is there the

adapter is implementable against verified facts instead of assumptions.

Anything unimplemented, unverified or assumed is listed here rather than left to inference. Current as of revision 2 of this document.

ITEM	STATUS
Sections A–M of this blueprint	ARCHITECTURE Design, not code. Phase 0 implements the foundation only; the rest is not built.
iPayMoney integration	NOT IMPLEMENTED Merchant account exists; the API is unverified and unreachable from the build environment. Interface and mock exist; the adapter throws. See section P.
Regulatory authorization (layer G)	UNRESOLVED Company registration (NIF, RCCM) establishes layer A only. Requires local counsel and, if needed, an application to the competent authority. Gates P6.
Legal document texts (Terms, Privacy, Seller, Instructor, Payout, Referral)	NOT WRITTEN The consent <i>architecture</i> exists; the documents themselves are a legal deliverable, not an engineering one.
Cloudflare Stream / R2, SMS provider, KYC provider	NOT SELECTED Recommended, not procured. No accounts, no confirmed pricing.
Latency assumption (<code>eu-west-3</code> over <code>af-south-1</code>)	UNVERIFIED Based on general routing, not measurement from Niamey. Verify in P0 or P1.
Effort estimates in section M	ESTIMATES Two to three engineers assumed. Not commitments.
ORM choice (Drizzle vs Prisma)	PROCEEDING ON THE RECOMMENDATION Phase 0 uses Drizzle. The decision genuinely depends on team composition, which is still unanswered — see section Q.
V2 (physical, delivery) and V3 (creator, services) architecture	DESIGNED, NOT BUILT Retained deliberately.



Decisions: settled, and still open

Settled — reflected throughout this document

DECISION	OUTCOME
Operating company	AFRI NEXT TECHNOLOGIE, <i>Entreprise Individuelle</i> , Niger, NIF + RCCM. Registration is layer A and nothing more — section 01.
Economic model	Afrinext is the commercial platform of record: it receives customer payments and pays beneficiaries under its own terms.
Launch scope	V1 = digital products and courses. V2 physical + delivery, V3 creator + services, both designed and deferred.
Launch market	Niger, XOF — as data, not as constants.
Payment provider	iPayMoney, merchant account held. Behind the provider interface; a second provider must remain possible.
Referral	Single level. Basis is Afrinext's realized commission, never gross. No payment for registration or recruitment.
Ledger	Double-entry design approved in principle. Not to be replaced by a balance field.
Consent	Versioned acceptance per document, per user. Establishes contract, not authorization.

Still open

None of these block Phase 0. Items 1 and 2 block later phases and are worth starting now because they have long lead times.

#	QUESTION	BLOCKS
1	Regulatory. Who is advising on layer G, and what authorization is Afrinext pursuing — its own licence, or operating under a licensed institution?	P6 payouts. Long lead time — start now.
2	iPayMoney documentation. The 13 items in section P. Sandbox credentials are the single most useful thing you can send.	P4 payment integration
3	Team composition. How many engineers, and what is their Prisma versus raw-SQL experience?	Settles the ORM choice; Phase 0 proceeds on Drizzle meanwhile
4	Hosting. Managed (Vercel + Neon, higher unit cost) or containers (Hetzner or Fly, cheaper, more operations)?	P0 deployment, not P0 code
5	SMS provider for OTP in Niger. Which aggregator, and what are the per-message economics?	Real OTP delivery. The OTP architecture is provider-agnostic, so this is not urgent.
6	Native app. Is the PWA sufficient at launch, or is store distribution required?	How much weight the REST layer carries
7	KYC. Which identity documents are practically verifiable in Niger, and is there an existing provider?	P6 withdrawal tiers
8	Legal document texts. Who drafts the Terms, Seller Terms, Payout Terms and the rest?	Nothing technical — the consent machinery works with any text

Phase 0 is authorised and in progress: the monorepo, the schema, authentication, scoped permissions, the consent tables, the audit log, the ledger with its property tests, and the payment-provider abstraction. Phase 1 does not begin without an explicit approval.